BPQ Dashboard

Version 1.5.19

User Manual

Amateur Radio Packet Node Operations Suite

Platform	Linux — Debian / Ubuntu / Raspberry Pi
Requirements	LinBPQ running · nginx or Apache · PHP 8.x
Target audience	Amateur radio operators — no prior Linux experience needed
Updated	October 2026
Repository	https://github.com/bpq-dashboard/bpq-dashboard

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1. What Is BPQ Dashboard?

BPQ Dashboard is a web-based monitoring and operations suite for amateur radio packet nodes running BPQ32 or LinBPQ. It runs on the same Linux computer as your packet node and gives you a rich browser interface to monitor connections, manage email-style BBS messages, view logs, track RF power, transfer files over packet via YAPP, run VARA HF keyboard sessions, and more — all from any device on your local network.

You access it by opening a web browser and going to your node's IP address. No software to install on the viewing device — it works on any phone, tablet or computer.

Feature	Description
RF Connections	VARA HF sessions, forwarding partners and their queues, forwarded messages (how they travelled, delivered or rejected), propagation, best bands and a station map. The home page
Chat Client	Browser window onto your BPQ chat server, through the station's own chat connection
VARA HF Terminal	Keyboard-to-keyboard HF sessions over your BPQ VARA port, from the browser
Telnet Client	Terminal on your node with a NetROM nodes list, command reference and **YAPP file transfer**
Email Client	Webmail-style client for BBS mail: Personal, NTS, bulletins, folders, rules, keep, address book; everything saved in the database
Message Monitor	BBS and BPQ mail-server activity from the daily logs, with a security view
System Logs	Statistics and a searchable viewer for BPQ's daily logs, plus MHeard and the routing table
Traffic Report	Per-station traffic from BPQ's traffic reports (7 days, 4 or 12 weeks)
Connect Log	Incoming connects by mode (NET/ROM, VARA, AX.25, Telnet), with a map
Rig Status	Frequency, mode, S-meter, PTT, TX power and the scan list, through flrig; optional network power switch
RF Power Monitor	Power and SWR history read from the radio through flrig (no separate wattmeter)
APRS Map	APRS-IS stations around you, messaging, your BBS's station info and an optional aprs.fi beacon
NWS Weather	National Weather Service alerts, nationwide severe weather, and posting alerts to your BBS
Maintenance	Copy-ready sysop commands, checks and the forwarding-partners editor
Firewall Status	What the internet can reach, IPv4 and IPv6, with fail2ban
Log Viewer	Recent lines of, and search through, the dashboard, parser, VARA, BPQ and web-server logs
System Audit	Automated check of security, resources, web server, database, services and timers
Day/Night Theme	Moon/sun button in the menu

How to use each page is in the **User Guide** (`USER-GUIDE.md`, and the Guide PDF in the menu). This manual covers installing, configuring, the optional tools and troubleshooting.

2. What's New

In v1.5.19

From the first Linux Mint and Ubuntu installs (N3MEL, KG9NI) and requests from sysops (K5DAT and others):

- **Choose your pages.** The installer asks which optional pages the station uses (Telnet Client, Chat, APRS map, VARA HF Terminal, VARA callsign check; Rig Status and RF Power Monitor follow the flrig question). Only their helper services are installed and started; the others are hidden from the menu (`config.php 'pages', 'radio' => 'enabled'`) and can be switched on later (Maintenance → *Optional pages*). The Rig pages are no longer deleted when you skip flrig.
- **Web server and port of your choice** (thanks K5DAT). nginx or Apache, on port 80 or its own port. On a machine that already serves other sites (for example nginx as a reverse proxy), existing sites, the default site and port 80 are left alone, `/etc/nginx` is backed up first, and a reverse-proxy example is written to `/root/bpq-dashboard-reverse-proxy.txt` (§4, *Step 5*).
- **LinBPQ in a home folder** (Ubuntu 21.04+, Mint 21+): the installer checks that the web server can reach the LinBPQ folder and its logs, and offers the narrow access fix (ACLs). Install Check prints the commands for your path.
- **The dashboard's own logs** (bpq-telnet, bpq-vara, Email Client, message-text job, NWS posting, forwarding tools) are written to `/var/log/bpq-dashboard/`, not LinBPQ's logs folder; on stations where the web user could only read that folder, bpq-telnet and bpq-vara used to stop at start. Weekly log rotation is installed.
- **VARA log from the TPRFN server:** TPRFN stations whose VARA HF sends its syslog to the TPRFN server can have the dashboard download it every 5 minutes (`vara-remote.timer`, §10.11) instead of running a receiver.
- **Firewall, optional:** `tools/setup-firewall.sh` sets up ufw with a question per port and never locks out your SSH session; the installer offers it at the end (default No). See §11.
- **In-place updates:** every release from now on has `update.sh`: `sudo bash update.sh` in the unzipped new release updates your install without a reinstall, keeps your settings and data, backs up what it replaces, and prints a one-line rollback (§4, *Updating*). Maintenance shows when a new release is out.
- **Maintenance page:** *Change admin password* (no SSH needed), *PKTNET forms* update with Undo, *Optional pages*, *Firewall setup* and *LinBPQ in a home folder* sections.
- **Email Client signature** (thanks N3MEL): Preferences → Signature, added to new messages (and optionally replies), kept on the server.
- **vara-validator** runs on any station: as the web user from the dashboard folder, settings in `config.php 'vara_validator'` (§10.9).
- **Clearer empty pages:** Traffic and Connect Log say why they're empty (no weekly report yet; `LogAllConnects=1` missing), and Install Check has rows for both. The installer loads the Traffic reports already on the machine. Install Check suggests PHP packages for the PHP version you run.

In v1.5.18

From the first Linux Mint install (thanks to N3MEL for the testing):

- **Email Client, message text job and forwarding queue log in on every BBS.** They waited for a `}` in BPQ's greeting after the password and reported *"Login failed"* when it never came. One shared login (`includes/bbs-login.php`) now accepts a login that lands at the node or straight in the BBS, whatever the greeting, and a failure says which step went wrong and shows BPQ's last line.

- **Telnet Client uses your BPQ ports.** The Node, BBS and Chat buttons, the Custom port and file-transfer mode use `bbs.port` from `config.php` and `FBBPORT=` from `bpq32.cfg` (or the new optional `bbs.fbb_port`) instead of 8010 / 8011, and the `bpq-telnet` service allows those ports.
- **Traffic Report finds BPQ's reports.** BPQ writes `Traffic_YYMMDD.txt` in the LinBPQ folder; the parser now looks there (`paths.linbpq`) as well as in `logs/`, and says where it looked when it finds none.
- **System Audit is more accurate:** LinBPQ running as `linbpq64` or `pilinbpq` is recognised (Install Check too); a dashboard service you switched off is *Info*, not *Critical*; the local-only ports `ssh -X` opens (6010+) aren't reported as SSH; the Maintenance page's own login check isn't counted as nginx errors; open station ports are reported as *open to every network (check your router)*.

In v1.5.17

- **Log Viewer opens every log.** Message text job, Email Client (BBS) and Dashboard log failed with *"JSON.parse: unexpected end of data"*: they hold raw BBS text, and one byte that wasn't valid UTF-8 made the server send an empty reply. Such bytes now show as **(replacement character)** and the rest of the log reads normally. If a log still can't be read, the page shows what the server sent back instead of a bare JSON error.

In v1.5.16

- **Fresh installs: admin pages and PHP work first time.** The v1.5.15 installer left the admin login file readable by root only, so every page behind the admin login answered **500**, and on some systems (seen on Ubuntu with PHP 8.5) it pointed nginx at a PHP socket that didn't exist, so PHP pages answered **502**. The installer now sets the login file to `root:www-data 640`, writes your PHP version's real socket, and tests both before it finishes. Install Check and System Audit flag either problem; §12 has the fixes by hand. Thanks to KG9NI for the report.

In v1.5.15

- **VARA HF log for RF Connections, set up by the installer:** a new question sets this server up to receive VARA HF's session log as syslog (rsyslog on UDP 514, from the VARA computer only), installs rsyslog where it's missing (Debian 12), and starts `vara-logger`. §10.11 explains the VARA HF side (Settings → VARA Setup → Syslog) step by step.
- **Fresh installs on Debian 12 / Ubuntu 24.04:** RF Connections no longer stays empty — `vara-logger` converts the new rsyslog timestamps to the form the parsers read. Install Check shows whether the VARA log is arriving.

In v1.5.14

- **The admin login guards everything that acts as your station** — Email Client, Chat, NWS posting, APRS sending, map saves, the admin pages, Install Check and Health Check — and the PHP refuses those actions itself unless the web server checked the login, so an old or hand-made web-server config fails closed. Kill and Forward are POST requests, other web sites can no longer call the dashboard from a browser unless you list them (`cors.allowed_origins`), and the Settings password is rate-limited. See `SECURITY.md`.
- **Email Client:** message text is saved on the server every 5 minutes, even with the page closed (BPQ can remove bulletins within days), messages open in a pop-up window, and columns can be resized.
- **RF Connections:** Forwarded Messages shows how each message travelled (VARA, NET/ROM, AXIP, Telnet, AX.25), whether the partner accepted, rejected or deferred it, and when it arrived, with one row per partner; counts are deliveries, not offers. The failure counts now add up and match System Logs.

- **APRS Map:** your BBS's station info, and an optional beacon that puts the BBS on aprs.fi.
- **Rig Status / RF Power Monitor:** radio model detection and meter readings for Icom, Kenwood, Elecraft and other radios through flrig, the scan list from `bpq32.cfg`, and TX power control.
- **APRS map key:** CARTO, which supplies the APRS map, now needs a free API key or it stamps "API KEY REQUIRED" across the map. Each station enters its own key in `config.php` (the installer asks for it). See **Section 4, Step 10** for how to get one.
- **NWS Alerts:Post to BBS** and **Post All** work again (they were rejected with "Missing required fields: subject, message"). Posts go to the address in the page's **Destination** box — as a bulletin (`SB`) for an address like `WX@GA`, as a private message (`SP`) when it starts with a callsign (2026-10-27; before, everything went as `SP`).
- **Your station on the pages (2026-10-27):** the Chat, VARA, NWS and Email Client pages show your callsign and node from `config.php` instead of placeholder text; access requests from the Chat and VARA pages are e-mailed by the server to `station.email`, whose address no longer appears on the pages. The NTS Report asks for the admin login, and `config.php.example` has the `smartplug` (power switch) section; with no switch set, nothing is probed.
- **Automatic NWS bulletins (optional, 2026-10-26):** the installer asks for your state; every 5 minutes the first issue of each new Warning or Watch for it is posted to the BBS as a bulletin (e.g. `WX@GA`). One bulletin per watch even when several NWS offices issue it; nothing expired, nothing twice (§10.4).
- **Credits:** `CREDITS.md` thanks the people and projects the dashboard is built on.
- **YAPP file transfer reworked (2026-10-24):** one click switches the Telnet Client to file-transfer mode, enters the BBS and lists its files; uploads by drag and drop with no command to type; long transfers no longer cut off after 2 minutes; Abort stops cleanly.
- **Chat:** the Online panel works, and the chat service rejoins by itself after BPQ's 2-hour idle disconnect.
- **Admin pages report this install accurately (2026-10-25):** System Audit, Firewall Status and Log Viewer were rewritten against the current code (no false alarms, IPv6, every daemon and timer), and `install.sh` offers to install their read-only sudo rules.
- **User Guide** checked page by page against the code, with new sysop reference chapters.

Also since v1.5.12 (first released in v1.5.13)

- **Safer, complete installer.** It now sets up the database fully (all tables), schedules the log parsers and a daily bulletin clean-up, installs every Python module the dashboard uses, and downloads the APRS map symbols. It also locks private files away from the web server and puts **all** admin pages behind your admin password. Earlier installers left `/admin/` open and could expose `bpq32.cfg` through the logs link, so re-running the new installer is recommended.
- **Your settings, not the code's.** Callsign, grid square, VARA hub, paths and APRS login are all read from `config.php`. Public pages show only the **centre of your grid square**, never your exact position.
- **Passwords in one place.** Database credentials can live in `db-config.php`, or the `db` section of `config.php`, and are no longer written into any program file.
- **Email Client:** message text is saved in the database, and **pinned** folders keep their messages even after you kill them on the BBS.
- **Bulletins older than 14 days** are cleaned up automatically, except in pinned groups and your own folders.
- **Traffic Report** picks up BPQ's weekly traffic files automatically.
- **Publishing check** (`tools/prepublish-check.py`) for anyone sharing their copy of the dashboard.

In v1.5.12

The biggest changes since v1.5.6:

Major new features

- **Database-backed RF Connections (10-15x faster page load)** — the RF Connections page now reads pre-parsed VARA HF sessions from MySQL instead of parsing multi-megabyte log files in your browser. A new background parser (`parse-vara-log.py`) runs every 5 minutes via cron to keep the table fresh. See section 10.8 for setup; the status pill shows **(DB)** when active.
- **Lazy BBS log loading** — the RF Connections page only fetches log files for the currently-selected time range (1 day for Today, 7 for 7d, 30 for 30d). Clicking a longer range lazy-loads the missing files. Initial page load is dramatically lighter.
- **YAPP File Transfer over packet radio** — receive and send binary files via YAPP/YAPP-C protocol directly from your browser, fully integrated into the Telnet Client page. Verified working over real RF with another sysop. Includes a **Browse Files** button that lists files available on the BBS so you can click to receive.
- **Email Client** (formerly "BBS Messages") — fully redesigned message client with NTS first-class folder, custom folders, multi-select, forwarding visibility, address book, message threading.
- **Nationwide NWS severe weather** — convective panel now covers all WFOs and SPC's nationwide watches (was Norman OK only).
- **Day/night theme toggle** in the shared navigation — appears on every page, persists across visits, every page is theme-aware.

Page additions and renames

- **Rig Status** — new page showing live frequency, mode, S-meter, power readings from flrig.
- **RF Power Monitor** — live RF telemetry read from flrig (existed in v1.5.6 but improved; migrated off WaveNode hardware — see RF-POWER-MONITOR-MIGRATION.md).
- **Telnet Client** — formerly "BPQ Telnet", now includes YAPP and FBB-mode support.
- **Email Client** rename — formerly "BBS Messages".
- **Message Monitor** — formerly "Email Monitor".
- **Hub Operations** — REMOVED (was vestigial).

Operations & infrastructure

- **Daemons monitored** — Maintenance and System Audit cover nginx, PHP-FPM, LinBPQ, bpq-telnet, bpq-chat, bpq-aprs, bpq-vara, vara-logger, vara-validator and rig-history-poller (and, since 2026-10-25, the message-bodies and bulletin-retention timers).
- **Firewall page rewrite** — accurate port categorization (Public / LAN Only / IP Restricted / Blocked / Localhost), proper source IP display, per-jail fail2ban cards.
- **Multi-domain SSL cert monitoring** — System Audit can check any number of certificates via the `ssl_domains` config setting.
- **Light-mode support** on every page (Maintenance, Firewall, System Audit, Rig Status, VARA, Telnet, RF Power Monitor, Log Viewer all now respond to the toggle).
- **Config-aware error messages** — Rig Status and others now show actual error details rather than hardcoded placeholder text.

Removed

- **Hub Operations page** — vestigial admin tool, fully cleaned up from nav, install-check, nginx config.

3. Before You Start

What you need

- A Linux computer running LinBPQ — Raspberry Pi 3/4/5, Ubuntu 20.04+, Debian 11+, or any Debian-based system
- An internet connection. The installer adds everything else, including the MariaDB database the Email Client needs
- LinBPQ already installed, configured and running. If you can telnet to your node it is ready.
- SSH access to your Linux computer, or a keyboard and monitor attached to it
- About 15 to 30 minutes with the guided installer

> ***Important:*** *BPQ Dashboard does NOT install or configure LinBPQ. LinBPQ must already be working before you start. The dashboard reads LinBPQ log files and connects to it via telnet — it does not replace it.*

Gather this information before you start

The installer asks about a dozen questions: your callsign, node, location, BPQ telnet port, sysop login, and the LinBPQ folder. **Section 4, Step 2** has the full list, with where to find each answer and an example. Fill it in before you start.

Linux command line basics

Some steps require typing commands into a terminal. If you are new to Linux:

- **SSH** — connects you to your Linux computer from another computer. Windows: use PuTTY or Windows Terminal. Mac/Linux: open Terminal and type `ssh username@192.168.x.x`
- **sudo** — runs a command as administrator. You may be asked for your password.
- **nano** — a simple text editor built into Linux. Arrow keys move the cursor. Ctrl+O saves. Ctrl+X exits.
- **Tab key** — auto-completes filenames and commands as you type them
- **Commands are case-sensitive** — type them exactly as shown, including capital letters

4. Installation — Step by Step

This chapter takes you from nothing to a working dashboard. **Most people only need Part A**: a guided installer does the work and asks you simple questions along the way. Part B is the same thing done by hand, for experienced Linux users.

You don't need to know Linux. You will type (or copy and paste) a few commands; each one is explained. When a step shows a box like this:

```
sudo apt update
```

type that line into the terminal and press **Enter**.

Part A — The guided installer (recommended)

Step 1 — Check you have what you need

- A computer running **Debian 11 or newer, Ubuntu 20.04 or newer, or Raspberry Pi OS (Bullseye or newer)**. A Raspberry Pi 3/4/5 is fine.
- **LinBPQ already installed and working** on that same computer.
- A way to type commands on it: a keyboard and screen, or an SSH connection. You must be able to use `sudo` (the installer needs administrator rights).
- An internet connection (the installer downloads software).

Step 2 — Write down your answers first

The installer asks these questions. Having the answers ready makes it quick.

The installer asks for…	What to enter	Where to find it	Example
Your callsign	Your amateur callsign	—	`W1AW`
Your BPQ node callsign with SSID	Your node's call-SSID	`NODECALL=` line in `bpq32.cfg`	`W1AW-4`
Your sysop email	Any email you read	—	`you@example.com`
Latitude / longitude	Decimal degrees. **South and West are negative**	Google Maps: right-click your location, click the numbers to copy them	`41.7148` / `-72.7272`
CARTO map key *(optional, press Enter to skip)*	The free key for the APRS map	See **Step 10 — Get a CARTO map key**. You can add it later	`cb1_xxxx_x_xxxxxxxx…`
Automatic NWS bulletins *(optional, default No)*	If Yes: your **2-letter state code**, the bulletin address (default `WX@` + state) and Warnings + Watches or Warnings only	The address should be a flood area your forwarding partners carry. See §10.4. You can turn it on later	`GA`, `WX@GA`, `1`

The installer asks for…	What to enter	Where to find it	Example
Where RF Connections gets your VARA HF log *(1, 2 or 3; default 1)*	**1** = VARA HF sends its syslog to this server: then the **IP address of the computer running VARA HF** (Enter = this server). **2** = it goes to the TPRFN server: then the web address of your file there, as the TPRFN server admin gives it (ends in `/<call>.vara`). **3** = no VARA HF	For 1, in VARA HF: Settings → VARA Setup → Syslog on, Host = this server, port 514, Station Name `H-<call-SSID>` (§10.11). For 2, ask the TPRFN server admin to set up your file first	`1`, `192.168.1.50`
BPQ telnet port	A number	In `bpq32.cfg`, the Telnet port section, `TCPPORT=`	`8010`
BPQ sysop username *(default `SYSOP`)*	First field of your `USER=` line	`bpq32.cfg`, e.g. `USER=John,secret,W1AW-4,NODE,SYSOP`	`John`
BPQ sysop password	Second field of that same line	as above	`secret`
Folder containing `bpq32.cfg` *(default `/opt/linbpq`)*	The LinBPQ folder. It should have a `logs` folder inside	Wherever you installed LinBPQ	`/home/pi/linbpq`
Web server *(1 = nginx, 2 = Apache)* and port *(default 80, or 8080 when the machine already serves other sites)*	The one you want the dashboard on. On a machine with your own sites or a reverse proxy, a free port such as `8080`, optionally on 127.0.0.1 only	`sudo ss -ltnp` lists ports in use	`2`, `8080`
Optional pages *(yes/no each)*	Telnet Client, Chat, APRS map, VARA HF Terminal, VARA callsign check	Answer N for a page you don't use (e.g. Chat if you use another chat hub, APRS if you run APRSIS32)	
Database password	**Invent a new one**, or just press Enter and one is made for you	—	

The installer asks for…	What to enter	Where to find it	Example
Admin username / password	**Invent them.** This is the *admin login*: it protects the admin pages and everything that acts as your station (Email Client, Chat, posting, sending)	—	`admin` / something strong
flrig *(if you use it)*	Whether flrig runs on this computer (then the radio's serial port) or another one (its address and port, default 12345)	flrig's Config → Setup → XML-RPC	`/dev/ttyUSB0` or `192.168.1.20`

Your map position on public pages is shown as the **centre of your grid square** (about 5 x 2.5 km), never your exact coordinates.

Step 3 — Download the dashboard

Open a terminal on the LinBPQ computer and run these four lines:

```
sudo apt update
sudo apt install -y wget unzip
cd ~
wget -O bpq-dashboard.zip https://github.com/bpq-dashboard/bpq-dashboard/archive/refs/tags/v1.5.19.zip
```

Then unpack it and go into the new folder:

```
unzip bpq-dashboard.zip
cd bpq-dashboard-1.5.19
```

> *If you downloaded the zip with a web browser instead, it is probably in your Downloads folder. Use* `cd ~/Downloads` *before the* `unzip` *line.*

Step 4 — Run the installer

```
sudo bash install.sh
```

Type your Linux password if asked. The screen explains what will happen; press **Enter** to begin.

> ***Normal:** when you type a password, nothing appears on screen — not even dots. Type it and press Enter.*

Step 5 — Answer the questions

Type the answers from your Step 2 table. A value in `[brackets]` is the default; press **Enter** to accept it.

Some questions are **yes/no**. The capital letter is the default:

Question	Answer
Use it for the dashboard? *(MariaDB already installed)* / Install MariaDB now?	**Y** (the Email Client and the fast pages need it)

Question	Answer
Back it up and reinstall fresh? *(only if the dashboard was installed before)*	**Y**
Which web server should run the dashboard? / Port	See Step 2. If the machine already serves other sites, the installer says so and leaves them alone
Reach the dashboard only through your reverse proxy (listen on 127.0.0.1)? *(only when sharing the machine)*	**y** if you will forward to it from your own nginx; **n** to open it on that port from your network too
Use the Telnet Client / Chat / APRS map / VARA HF Terminal / VARA callsign check page?	**Y** for the pages you use. **N** hides a page and skips its helper; add it later (Maintenance → *Optional pages*)
Set up flrig now (for Rig Status / RF Power Monitor)?	**Y** if you use flrig, then answer whether it runs on this server. **n** hides the Rig Status and RF Power Monitor pages (both need flrig); everything else, including BPQ's own CAT control of the radio, works without it
Apply that fix now (setfacl)? *(only if the web server can't reach your LinBPQ folder)*	**Y** — gives the web server read access to the LinBPQ folder and its logs only (§12, *LinBPQ in a home folder*)
Start the page helpers now (and at every boot)?	**Y**
Install those sudo rules (/etc/sudoers.d/www-data-tools)?	**Y** — read-only rules the Firewall Status and System Audit pages need, plus the Maintenance page's *Change admin password* helper
Set up a basic firewall (ufw) now? *(default No)*	**N** to do it later; **y** runs `tools/setup-firewall.sh` (§11)

The whole run takes 5–15 minutes, mostly downloading. Everything the installer does is also written to a log file named on the first screen (`/tmp/bpq-dashboard-install-….log`).

Step 6 — Read the summary

At the end you'll see something like:

```
Results:
  OK 41 steps succeeded
   3 warnings
  X 0 errors
```

- **[OK]** worked.
- **[!]** is something to know about, not a failure. For example, *"Skipping flrig setup"* just means you answered **n**.
- **[X]** is an error. It is listed underneath with what went wrong. The log file has the details; include it if you ask for help.

Just before the summary, the installer asks the web server for three addresses the way a browser would: a PHP file (expects **200**; **502** means the web server can't reach PHP), an admin page with no login (expects **401**; **500** means the web server can't read the admin login file) and the same page with your admin login (expects **200**). A [X] on any of them names the fix; Section 12 has the details.

Step 7 — Open your dashboard

On the LinBPQ computer, find its network address:

```
hostname -I
```

The first number (for example `192.168.1.50`) is its address. On any computer, phone or tablet on your network, open a web browser and go to:

```
http://192.168.1.50/
```

(use your own number; if you chose another port, add it: `http://192.168.1.50:8080/`). The **RF Connections** page should appear. Bookmark it.

Step 8 — Run the self-test

Go to:

```
http://192.168.1.50/install-check.php
```

Log in with the **admin username and password** you invented. The page checks everything the dashboard needs and shows each item in green, amber or red. **Every red item shows the exact command that fixes it.**

A *daemon heartbeat* line can stay red for a minute or two while the helpers connect to LinBPQ. Pages you switched off are passed as *not used*.

Step 9 — The helper services

Small background programs power the live pages. Since v1.5.19 the installer installs and starts the ones for the pages you chose; this table is for checking them, or for turning one on later (also Maintenance → *Optional pages*, which first installs the unit file):

Service	What it's for	Turn it on
`bpq-telnet`	Telnet Client page and YAPP file transfers	`sudo systemctl enable --now bpq-telnet`
`bpq-chat`	Chat page	`sudo systemctl enable --now bpq-chat`
`bpq-aprs`	APRS map	`sudo systemctl enable --now bpq-aprs`
`bpq-vara`	VARA HF Terminal page	`sudo systemctl enable --now bpq-vara`
`vara-logger`	Records VARA HF activity for the RF Connections page when VARA HF sends its syslog to this server (see §10.11)	`sudo systemctl enable --now vara-logger`
`vara-remote.timer`	Downloads your VARA log from the TPRFN server instead (§10.11)	`sudo systemctl enable --now vara-remote.timer`
`rig-history-poller` *(flrig installs)*	Records power and SWR for the RF Power Monitor	`sudo systemctl enable --now rig-history-poller`

To check one is running, for example `bpq-aprs`:

```
systemctl status bpq-aprs
```

Look for **active (running)** in green. Press **q** to get back to the prompt.

The installer already scheduled the **log parsers** (and loaded the weekly Traffic reports already on the machine), which fill the RF Connections, Traffic and System Logs pages every 5 minutes, the **message-text job** (`message-bodies.timer`, saves new BBS messages' text every 5 minutes) and a **daily clean-up** that deletes bulletins older than 14 days, except in groups you pin with in the Email Client. (All of these need the

database.) Pages may look empty for the first few minutes. If you said Yes to automatic NWS bulletins, `nws-auto-post.timer` is running too (no database needed); see §10.4.

Telnet and VARA pages

The installer's site file (nginx or Apache) puts the **Telnet Client** and the **VARA HF Terminal**, their live connections (`/ws/telnet` to the `bpq-telnet` service on port 8765, `/ws/vara` to `bpq-vara` on 8767, both listening on the server only) and the NetROM list (`bpq-nodes-api.php`) behind the admin login. The VARA connection has no login of its own, so this is what stops anyone else from transmitting as your station. Both pages work over HTTP or HTTPS. On Apache the installer also turns on `proxy_wstunnel` for these connections and runs PHP through PHP-FPM (`a2enconf php*-fpm`).

Both read `config.php`; there is nothing to edit in the scripts:

- **Telnet NetROM Nodes list:** logs in with `bbs.user` / `bbs.pass` and leaves your own node (`station.node`) out of the list.
- **VARA HF Terminal:** the `bpq-vara` service logs in with `bbs.user` / `bbs.pass` and finds your VARA HF port in `bpq32.cfg` (the first `DRIVER=VARA` port that isn't VARA FM). Set it yourself if it picks the wrong one: `'vara' => ['bpq_port' => 3],`. After starting it, check what it chose:

```
sudo systemctl enable --now bpq-vara
sudo journalctl -u bpq-vara -n 5 | grep "VARA HF ="
```

`www-data` must be able to read `bpq32.cfg` for this (it already must for the Rig page). If it can't, or there's no VARA port, the service stops and the journal says what to set.

Step 10 — Optional settings

Your settings live in one file. To open it:

```
sudo nano /var/www/bpq-dashboard/config.php
```

Use the arrow keys to move. To save, press **Ctrl+O** then **Enter**. To exit, press **Ctrl+X**. Things you might change:

- **CARTO map key (APRS map):** see *Get a CARTO map key* just below. If you skipped it in the installer, the APRS map shows "API KEY REQUIRED" across every tile until you add it.
- **Send on APRS-IS:** by default the APRS map only *receives*. To send messages, or to beacon your BBS to aprs.fi (APRS Map → (home) BBS Info → Edit), set your passcode in the `'aprs'` section: `'passcode' => 'YOUR_PASSCODE',`. Get your passcode from https://apps.magicbug.co.uk/passcode/. Then run `sudo systemctl restart bpq-aprs`. You don't need LinBPQ's own APRS (`APRSDIGI`) for either; if you do run it, give it a different SSID from the dashboard's.
- **VARA HF hub:** if you run a VARA HF hub, put its call-SSID in `'hub' => 'W1AW-7',` (in the `'station'` section) to get band and frequency history on RF Connections.
- **flrig (rig control):** the `'radio'` section, if you skipped it in the installer.
- **QRZ.com locations on the maps:** with a QRZ XML data subscription, put your QRZ login in the `'qrz'` section (password in single quotes). Without it, US stations are still placed through callook.info. Check it with `sudo -u www-data php /var/www/bpq-dashboard/callsign-lookup.php --qrz-test` (never shows the password).

Web pages pick up changes immediately; only the helper services need a restart.

Get a CARTO map key

The APRS map is drawn with map tiles from CARTO. CARTO now asks for a free API key; without one the map still loads but is stamped **"API KEY REQUIRED"** all over. Each station needs its own key.

1. Go to **https://www.carto.com/basemaps/apikey/** and fill in the request form (or go straight to **https://dashboard.basemaps.carto.com**). You sign in with a link CARTO emails you; there is no password.
2. Create a key. Personal, club and other non-commercial use is free up to 5 million map tiles a month, far more than a station dashboard uses.
3. **Limit the key to your dashboard's web address** (for example `https://bpq.example.com`) in CARTO's dashboard. The key is sent to every visitor's browser along with the map, so anyone can see it; the address limit stops others from using it on their own sites.
4. Copy the key and put it in `config.php`:

```
'map' => [
    'carto_key' => 'cb1_xxxx_x_xxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxx',
],
```

Use single quotes. If your `config.php` has no `'map'` section (installed before 2026-10-20), add the lines above inside the main `return [ ... ];`, for example just before the `'qrz'` section.

5. Open the APRS map and press **Ctrl+Shift+R** so your browser drops the old stamped tiles. Install Check's **CARTO map key (APRS map)** row turns green once the key is set.

If the stamp is still there with a key set, check in CARTO's dashboard that the key is active and that its address limit matches the address you use to open the dashboard.

Step 11 — Stay safe

- Everything that acts as your station (Email Client, Chat, NWS posting, APRS sending, map saves, the admin pages, Install Check, Health Check) is protected by your admin login, and so are the Telnet and VARA pages. Keep that password private.
- **Never share** `config.php`. It contains your BBS and database passwords.
- Keep Install Check: it's behind the login, and it's the quickest way to check the install after every update.
- If you want the dashboard reachable **from the internet**, set up HTTPS and check the firewall first, **IPv6 included**: see Section 11 and `SECURITY.md`.

Updating to a newer version

Since v1.5.19 every release has `update.sh`, which updates your dashboard in place: no reinstall, no questions, nothing to re-enter. It also works on an install of an older version.

1. Download and unzip the new version as in Step 3 (use its version number):

```
cd ~
wget -O bpq-dashboard.zip https://github.com/bpq-dashboard/bpq-dashboard/archive/refs/tags/vX.Y.Z.zip
unzip -o bpq-dashboard.zip
cd bpq-dashboard-X.Y.Z
```

2. Look at what it will do (changes nothing):

```
sudo bash update.sh --dry-run
```

It finds your dashboard (`/var/www/bpq-dashboard`, or the folder your nginx/Apache site serves; add `--web-root /path` if it asks) and lists the files it will update, add and remove.

3. Update:

```
sudo bash update.sh
```

4. Press **Ctrl+Shift+R** on each page once (the menu is cached), then open Install Check.

What it keeps: `config.php` (and `db-config.php` etc.), `data/` (partners, settings, saved stations), `cache/`, the `logs` link to LinBPQ, `pktnet-forms/`, `img/`, `yapp-files/`, everything in the database, your nginx or Apache site file, your firewall, and everything outside the dashboard folder.

What it does: backs up every file it replaces or removes to `/root/bpq-dashboard-update-<date>/` (with a restore script and a log); copies the new and changed files, keeping owner and mode, and checks each one; removes files the release dropped (old PDFs, retired pages); applies the database updates in `sql/migrations.list` (each is safe to repeat); refreshes the systemd units and sudo rules the installer set up, only where they changed (a unit you wrote yourself is left alone); restarts only the helper services whose program or unit changed; and records the version in `VERSION` and `MANIFEST.md5`. Maintenance → *Install check, updates & backups* shows the installed and latest versions.

Files you edited on the server (from v1.5.19 on it can tell, using the installed `MANIFEST.md5`) are listed before it starts; they are replaced with the new version and your copy stays in the backup.

Undo: the last lines it prints include the exact command, e.g. `sudo bash update.sh --rollback /root/bpq-dashboard-update-20261115-101500`. It puts back every file, unit and sudo rule as it was. Database updates stay (they only add tables and columns, which the older version ignores).

When the web-server template changed (`nginx-bpq-dashboard.conf`, `bpq-dashboard.conf`), `update.sh` says so but doesn't touch your live site file; the CHANGELOG says what to add.

A full reinstall is still possible: run the new version's `sudo bash install.sh`, give the same answers, and answer **Y** to *"Back it up and reinstall fresh?"*. Your database is kept; `config.php` is written new, so re-apply optional settings (Step 10) from the old `config.php` in `/var/www/bpq-dashboard.backup-<date>`.

Coming from an older version? These one-time steps bring earlier history into features added since then. Each is safe to run again. Use your real backup folder name and callsign (`W` is the web folder):

```
W=/var/www/bpq-dashboard
```

- **Email Client folders kept in files** (`data/messages/*.json`, versions before July 2026): copy them from the backup and import them into the database. The JSON files are only read, never deleted.

```
sudo cp -a /var/www/bpq-dashboard.backup-<date>/data/messages $W/data/
sudo chown -R www-data:www-data $W/data/messages
sudo -u www-data php $W/migrate-json-to-db.php
```

- **System Logs history** (the page reads the database since v1.5.13). Add `--dry-run` first to see what it would load; a year of logs can take several minutes:

```
sudo -u www-data python3 $W/scripts/parse-system-logs.py --logs-dir $W/logs --backfill --verbose
```

- **RF Connections forwarded messages**: label older messages as RF (VARA) or not, for the Forwarding Partners tiles. Use the number of days your BBS logs go back:

```
sudo -u www-data python3 $W/scripts/parse-vara-log.py --bbs-log-dir $W/logs --my-callsign W1AW --rescan-
```

- **Message text** for messages already in the database: `sudo -u www-data php $W/scripts/fetch-message-bodies.php --backfill`

- **Forwarded Messages delivery status** (Via, Status, Received; added 2026-10-06): installers before 2026-10-25 didn't load this migration. Load it once (safe to repeat), then re-scan with the `--rescan-messages-days` line above:

```
sudo mysql bpqdash < sql/2026-10-06-rf-messages-delivery.sql
```

(`bpqdash` is the database name from `config.php`; run it in the unzipped folder.) System Audit lists any update your database still lacks.

- **Telnet and VARA pages, NetROM list** (2026-10-25): the reinstall writes the new site file and the new scripts read `config.php`. If you had edited `scripts/bpq-vara-daemon.py` or `bpq-nodes-api.php` by hand, check `config.php`'s `bbs` login and `station.node` (and `vara.bpq_port` if your VARA port isn't found), then `sudo systemctl restart bpq-vara`. Both pages now ask for the admin login.
- **NTS Report login and power switch (2026-10-27):** the reinstall writes the new site file, which puts `nts-forwarding-report.php` behind the admin login; with a hand-made site file the report answers "needs the dashboard admin login" until you add it to the login locations (compare `nginx-bpq-dashboard.conf`). If Rig Status showed your power switch without a `smartplug` section in `config.php` (the old built-in `192.168.1.100`, `admin`/`admin`), add the section with those values.
- **VARA HF log on Debian 12 / Ubuntu 24.04 (2026-10-27):** rsyslog there writes timestamps the parsers didn't read, so RF Connections stayed empty; the new `vara-logger.sh` converts them — after updating, `sudo systemctl restart vara-logger`. If the installer never asked you about the VARA HF log receiver, set it up with §10.11 steps 1–3.
- **v1.5.19 (from 1.5.18 or earlier):**
- The dashboard's own logs move to `/var/log/bpq-dashboard/`. A reinstall creates it; by hand: `sudo mkdir -p /var/log/bpq-dashboard /var/lib/bpq-dashboard && sudo chown www-data:www-data /var/log/bpq-dashboard /var/lib/bpq-dashboard && sudo chmod 750 /var/log/bpq-dashboard /var/lib/bpq-dashboard`, then restart `bpq-telnet` and `bpq-vara`. Older log files stay in `logs/`; the Log Viewer shows them until the new ones fill.
- Optional pages: an existing `config.php` has no `'pages'` section, so every page stays on. Add one to hide pages you don't use (Maintenance → *Optional pages*). If an earlier install left Rig Status / RF Power Monitor out (no flrig), they come back as files but stay hidden while `'radio' => ['enabled' => false]`.
- `vara-validator`: the new unit runs as `www-data` from the dashboard folder and reads `config.php` `'vara_validator'` (§10.9). If you run the old copy in `/usr/local/bin`, keep it until you have copied your settings into `config.php`.
- The Maintenance page's *Change admin password* needs the helper in `/usr/local/sbin` and its sudo rule (§11, *Configure sudoers*); a reinstall offers both.
- **Apache installs from before 2026-10-25:** the installer didn't hook PHP-FPM into Apache, so PHP pages were sent as text and nothing that reads data worked. Re-running the installer fixes it; by hand: `sudo a2enmod proxy_fcgi setenvif proxy proxy_http proxy_wstunnel && sudo a2enconf php*-fpm && sudo systemctl reload apache2`.

Part B — Manual install (experienced users)

These are the same steps the guided installer performs. Paths assume the standard web folder `/var/www/bpq-dashboard`.

1. Packages

```
sudo apt update
sudo apt install -y nginx php-fpm php-cli php-curl php-mbstring php-xml php-mysql php-sqlite3 php-gd \
    mariadb-server python3 python3-pymysql python3-reportlab python3-websockets \
    python3-requests python3-serial python3-pexpect rsync curl unzip apache2-utils
```

2. Database (choose your own password)

```
sudo mysql <<'SQL'
CREATE DATABASE IF NOT EXISTS bpqdash CHARACTER SET utf8mb4;
CREATE USER IF NOT EXISTS 'bpqdash'@'localhost' IDENTIFIED BY 'CHOOSE_A_PASSWORD';
GRANT ALL PRIVILEGES ON bpqdash.* TO 'bpqdash'@'localhost';
SQL
for f in sql/2026-07-messages-schema.sql data/rf-connections-schema.sql data/prop-decisions-schema.sql \
         data/sessions-stations-schema.sql data/traffic-schema.sql data/system-logs-schema.sql \
         sql/2026-09-21-rf-messages-medium.sql sql/2026-09-26-message-keep-and-bodies.sql \
         sql/2026-10-06-rf-messages-delivery.sql; do
    sudo mysql bpqdash < "$f"
done
```

Run this from the unzipped folder. All files are safe to re-run. The last three are updates: on a new database they add the columns the base schema doesn't have yet (the delivery-status one is needed for Forwarded Messages' Via/Status columns).

3. Files

```
W=/var/www/bpq-dashboard
sudo mkdir -p $W
sudo rsync -a --exclude install.sh --exclude .git --exclude private ./ $W/
sudo mkdir -p $W/cache/aprs $W/cache/chat-sessions $W/cache/network $W/data/backups $W/img
echo '{"partners":[]}' | sudo tee $W/data/partners.json >/dev/null
sudo curl -fsSL -o $W/img/aprs-symbols-pri.png https://raw.githubusercontent.com/hessu/aprs-symbols/master
sudo curl -fsSL -o $W/img/aprs-symbols-alt.png https://raw.githubusercontent.com/hessu/aprs-symbols/master
sudo bash $W/scripts/fetch-forms.sh $W    # message forms for the Email Client (optional; re-run with --fo
sudo chown -R www-data:www-data $W
```

4. Configuration

```
sudo cp $W/config.php.example $W/config.php
sudo nano $W/config.php
sudo chown www-data:www-data $W/config.php && sudo chmod 640 $W/config.php
```

At minimum, set:

Setting	Description	Example
`station.callsign`	Your callsign	`'W1AW'`
`station.node`	Your BPQ node (callsign-SSID)	`'W1AW-4'`
`station.grid`	Grid square. Public pages (RF Connections map) show the **centre of this square**, never your exact position	`'FN31PR'`
`station.hub`	Optional: your VARA HF hub SSID; enables band/frequency correlation from your own BBS log	`'W1AW-7'`
`station.lat`	Latitude (exact; used server-side only, never published)	`41.7148`
`station.lon`	Longitude (exact; used server-side only, never published)	`-72.7272`

Setting	Description	Example
features.bbs_write	false makes the Email Client read-only: Send, Forward and Kill are refused (NWS posting has its own features.nws_post)	true
cors.allowed_origins	Other web sites allowed to call the dashboard from a browser. Leave empty unless you need it; the dashboard's own pages don't	['https://club.example.org']
map.carto_key	Free CARTO key for the APRS map tiles (see Part A, Step 10 — *Get a CARTO map key*). Without it the map is stamped "API KEY REQUIRED"	'cb1_xxxx_x_…'
paths.linbpq	Your LinBPQ directory (bpq32.cfg, WP.cfg, linmail.cfg)	'/home/linbpq'
logs.vara_file	Your VARA log file name inside paths.logs, or a full path (the TPRFN download uses /var/log/bpq-dashboard/<call>.vara)	'w1aw.vara'
bbs.host	LinBPQ host	'127.0.0.1'
bbs.port	LinBPQ telnet port	8010
bbs.user	Your BPQ sysop user	'W1AW'
bbs.pass	Its password. Also the password for the VARA page, the Rig page controls and the partners editor	'mypassword'
aprs.callsign / aprs.passcode	APRS-IS login; passcode -1 = receive only	'W1AW-1' / '12345'
qrz.username / qrz.password	Optional QRZ XML login for map locations	
messages.bulletin_text	Which bulletins' text the server saves: all, pinned, none	'all'
nws.post_destination	Default address for NWS page posts; empty = WX@<nws.auto_post.area>, else WX@ALLUS. A callsign address is sent as SP, anything else as a bulletin (SB)	'WX@ALLUS'
nws.auto_post	Automatic Warning/Watch bulletins (nws-auto-post.timer, §10.4)	enabled => false
smartplug	Optional network power switch for Rig Status: host, user, pass, outlet (§10.7). host empty = none; nothing is contacted	'host' => ''
radio.flrig_host	flrig host IP	'192.168.1.100'
radio.flrig_port	flrig XML-RPC port	12345
radio.enabled	false when flrig was skipped: Rig Status and RF Power Monitor hidden from the menu, no history poller	true

Setting	Description	Example
`pages`	Optional pages (v1.5.19): `telnet`, `chat`, `aprs`, `vara`, `vara_validator`; `false` hides the page from the menu (install its helper only for pages that are `true`). Missing = on	`['chat' => false, 'aprs' => false]`
`paths.app_logs`	Where the dashboard writes its own logs (v1.5.19; must exist and be writable by the web user)	`'/var/log/bpq-dashboard'`
`vara_remote`	VARA HF log downloaded from the TPRFN server (§10.11): `enabled`, `url`	`['enabled' => true, 'url' => 'https://<TPRFN server>/w1aw.vara']`
`vara_validator`	VARA callsign check settings (§10.9)	
`radio.bpq_radio`	bpq32.cfg RADIO number for the Rig page scan list; `0` = the block with an FLRIG line	`0`
`radio.max_power`	Highest TX power (W) the Rig page may set; `0` = the radio's maximum	`50`
`radio.min_power` / `radio.model`	Lowest TX power (default 1); force a radio profile instead of auto-detect	`5` / `'FTdx3000'`
`security_mode`	`'public'` for an internet-facing site with no login in front (Section 11)	`'local'`
`ssl_domains`	Domains to monitor for cert expiry (optional)	`['bpq.example.com']`

Put the database name, user and password from step 2 in the `'db'` section. Alternatively, put them in `db-config.php` (copy `db-config.php.example`), which takes priority.

5. Link the BPQ logs

Link LinBPQ's **logs** folder. Never link the whole LinBPQ folder: `bpq32.cfg` holds your passwords.

```
sudo rm -rf $W/logs
sudo ln -s /path/to/linbpq/logs $W/logs
sudo mkdir -p /var/log/bpq-dashboard /var/lib/bpq-dashboard     # the dashboard's own logs; kept copies (v
sudo chown www-data:www-data /var/log/bpq-dashboard /var/lib/bpq-dashboard
sudo chmod 750 /var/log/bpq-dashboard /var/lib/bpq-dashboard
```

LinBPQ inside a home folder (Ubuntu 21.04+, Mint 21+)? Give the web server access as in §12, *LinBPQ in a home folder*, then check: `sudo -u www-data ls /path/to/linbpq/logs | head -3`.

6. Web server

For a LAN-only server, the simplest safe choice is to let `install.sh` write it. By hand, start from `bpq-dashboard.conf` (HTTPS, public-facing) and keep **all** of its `return 403` blocks. They stop `scripts/`, `data/`, `.sql`, backup files and anything in `logs/` other than log files from being downloaded. The template protects `/admin/` with the password file `/etc/nginx/.bpq-mgmt-auth`. Create it:

```
sudo htpasswd -cB /etc/nginx/.bpq-mgmt-auth admin
sudo chown root:www-data /etc/nginx/.bpq-mgmt-auth
sudo chmod 640 /etc/nginx/.bpq-mgmt-auth
```

The last two lines matter: `htpasswd -c` makes the file readable by root only, and nginx's workers (user `www-data`) then can't read it, so every admin page answers **500**.

Both templates name PHP 8.3's socket (`fastcgi_pass unix:/run/php/php8.3-fpm.sock;`). Use your own version's socket — `ls /run/php/` shows it, for example `php8.5-fpm.sock` — and always the versioned name, not `php-fpm.sock`:

```
ls /run/php/
SITE=/etc/nginx/sites-available/bpq-dashboard     # your site file
sudo sed -i 's|php8.3-fpm.sock|php8.5-fpm.sock|g' $SITE   # your version
```

On a machine that already runs nginx for other sites (a reverse proxy, K5DAT's case): don't replace its default site. Either add the dashboard as its own `server { }` block with its own `listen` port or `server_name` (from `nginx-bpq-dashboard.conf`, without `default_server`), or run it under Apache on another port and forward to it. Apache on port 8080, reachable only through your nginx:

```
sudo apt install -y apache2 libapache2-mod-fcgid      # if port 80 is nginx's, Apache's first start fails
sudo sed -i 's/^Listen 80$/# Listen 80/' /etc/apache2/ports.conf
echo 'Listen 127.0.0.1:8080' | sudo tee -a /etc/apache2/ports.conf
sudo a2dissite 000-default
```

then write the site as `install.sh` does (its Apache block, with `<VirtualHost 127.0.0.1:8080>`), and in your nginx's server block for the dashboard's host name:

```
location /     { proxy_pass http://127.0.0.1:8080; proxy_set_header Host $host;
                 proxy_set_header X-Forwarded-For $proxy_add_x_forwarded_for; proxy_read_timeout 120s; }
location /ws/  { proxy_pass http://127.0.0.1:8080; proxy_http_version 1.1;
                 proxy_set_header Upgrade $http_upgrade; proxy_set_header Connection "upgrade"; proxy_read
```

The guided installer (v1.5.19) does all of this when you choose Apache and port 8080 on such a machine, backs up `/etc/nginx` and writes the proxy block to `/root/bpq-dashboard-reverse-proxy.txt`. Give the dashboard its own host name or port: a sub-path such as `/dashboard/` doesn't work.

Both templates have the `/ws/telnet` and `/ws/vara` blocks: `nginx-bpq-dashboard.conf` puts them and the two pages behind the admin login, like the installer; `bpq-dashboard.conf` limits `/ws/telnet` to private addresses and puts `/ws/vara` behind the admin login as well.

7. PHP time limit

```
for d in /etc/php/*/fpm/conf.d; do printf 'max_execution_time = 90\n' | sudo tee $d/99-bpq-dashboard.ini;
sudo systemctl restart 'php*-fpm'
```

8. Schedule the log parsers and the bulletin clean-up

Replace `W1AW` with your callsign:

```
sudo mkdir -p /var/log/bpq-dashboard && sudo chown www-data:www-data /var/log/bpq-dashboard
sudo tee /etc/cron.d/bpq-dashboard >/dev/null <<'CRON'
*/5 * * * * www-data /usr/bin/python3 /var/www/bpq-dashboard/scripts/parse-vara-log.py --bbs-log-dir /var/
*/5 * * * * www-data /usr/bin/python3 /var/www/bpq-dashboard/scripts/parse-traffic-report.py --days 8 >> /
*/5 * * * * www-data /usr/bin/python3 /var/www/bpq-dashboard/scripts/parse-system-logs.py >> /var/log/bpq-
CRON
for u in bulletin-retention.service bulletin-retention.timer message-bodies.service message-bodies.timer;
  sed "s|/var/www/bpq-dashboard|$W|g" $W/$u | sudo tee /etc/systemd/system/$u >/dev/null
done
sudo systemctl daemon-reload && sudo systemctl enable --now bulletin-retention.timer message-bodies.timer
sudo -u www-data python3 $W/scripts/parse-traffic-report.py --backfill     # load the Traffic reports alre
```

Log rotation for the dashboard's own logs (v1.5.19):

```
printf '/var/log/bpq-dashboard/*.log {\n    weekly\n    rotate 8\n    compress\n    delaycompress\n    mis
```

`message-bodies.timer` saves the text of new BBS messages to the database every 5 minutes, whether or not the Email Client is open (BPQ can remove bulletins within days). Bulletins: `'messages' =>`

`['bulletin_text' => 'all']` in config.php; `'pinned'` saves only groups pinned , `'none'` none. To fetch text for messages already in the database once: `sudo -u www-data php $W/scripts/fetch-message-bodies.php --backfill`.

`--days 8` matters: some BPQ versions write the traffic report weekly rather than daily.

9. Helper services (only for the pages you use; set the others to `false` in `config.php 'pages'`)

```
sudo cp $W/bpq-telnet.service $W/bpq-chat.service $W/bpq-aprs.service $W/bpq-vara.service $W/vara-logger.s
sudo cp $W/rig-history-poller.service /etc/systemd/system/     # only with flrig
sudo systemctl daemon-reload
sudo systemctl enable --now bpq-telnet bpq-chat bpq-aprs bpq-vara vara-logger   # leave out the ones you d
sudo systemctl enable --now rig-history-poller                  # only with flrig
```

The service files run the daemons from `$W/scripts/` (`vara-logger` runs `$W/vara-logger.sh` as root, because it reads `/var/log/syslog`). Don't copy the scripts elsewhere. Edit `$W/vara-logger.sh` so `OUTPUT_FILE` names your `<callsign>.vara` file. The Telnet and VARA pages need the `/ws/telnet` and `/ws/vara` blocks from `nginx-bpq-dashboard.conf` (Part A, Step 9 explains what they do).

10. Check with `install-check.php`, as in Part A, Step 8.

5. Testing Your Installation

Visit `http://YOUR_SERVER_IP/install-check.php` and log in with your admin username and password. It checks:

- every dashboard page, API and script is present (the Rig pages only when flrig is set up)
- `config.php` values are filled in, including the APRS, CARTO, CORS and radio settings
- the logs folder is readable and the cache, data and YAPP folders writable
- PHP, its extensions and the database work; the tables exist; the Python modules are installed; the log parsers are scheduled
- the services are installed and running
- the web-server site file serves this folder, the admin folder and the station-acting pages are behind the login, and the login reaches PHP
- LinBPQ is reachable, with mail and chat enabled, and the FLRIG `RADIO` block can be read

Each failure shows the command that fixes it. `health-check.php` (same login) is a shorter diagnostic that also tries a BBS login; it runs from the command line too: `sudo -u www-data php /var/www/bpq-dashboard/health-check.php`. After the first day, run **System Audit** (Admin → Audit) as well.

6. Dashboard Pages Reference

> ***Core vs. optional:*** *the pages below work once Section 4 is done. The forwarding tools, the callsign validator and the other extras in Section 10 are add-ons; skip the ones you don't need.*

The **User Guide** describes every page in detail. In short, with what each needs on the server:

Page	Address	Login	Needs
RF Connections (home)	`/` or `/bpq-rf-connections.html`	none (saving partners/locations: admin)	`vara-logger` or `vara-remote.timer` (§10.11), `parse-vara-log.py`, BBS logs
Traffic Report	`/bpq-traffic.html`	none	`Traffic_*.txt`, `parse-traffic-report.py`
System Logs	`/bpq-system-logs.html`	none	BBS/TCP/CMS logs, `parse-system-logs.py`; optional `nodes-rtt.sh` (§10.12)
Connect Log	`/bpq-connect-log.html`	none	`ConnectLog_*.log` (`LogAllConnects=1` in `bpq32.cfg`)
Message Monitor	`/bpq-email-monitor.html`	none (reading bulletins: admin)	BBS and TCP logs
Email Client	`/bbs-messages.html`	admin	database, `bbs` login in `config.php`, `message-bodies.timer`, `bulletin-retention.timer`
NWS Weather	`/nws-dashboard.html`	none (posting: admin)	api.weather.gov; `bbs` login for posting
Chat Client	`/bpq-chat.html`	admin	`bpq-chat`
APRS Map	`/bpq-aprs.html`	none (sending, BBS info: admin)	`bpq-aprs`, `aprs` and `map` in `config.php`
VARA HF Terminal	`/bpq-vara.html`	admin + BBS password	`bpq-vara` (`bbs` login, VARA port from `bpq32.cfg` or `vara.bpq_port`), flrig, `RADIO 2` FLRIG block in `bpq32.cfg`
Telnet Client	`/bpq-telnet.html`	admin + your BPQ login	`bpq-telnet`; `bpq-nodes-api.php` for the nodes list (`bbs` login, `station.node`)
Rig Status	`/rig-status.html`	none (controls: BBS password)	flrig; optional `smartplug`
RF Power Monitor	`/rf-power-monitor.html`	none	flrig, `rig-history-poller`
Maintenance, Firewall Status, Log Viewer, System Audit	`/admin/…`	admin	sudo rules (§11) for Firewall/Audit and for *Change admin password*
Install Check, Health Check	`/install-check.php`, `/health-check.php`	admin	—

Chat, APRS Map, VARA HF Terminal, Telnet Client, Rig Status and RF Power Monitor are **optional pages** (v1.5.19): switched off in `config.php 'pages'` (or `'radio' => 'enabled'`) they are hidden from the menu and their helper isn't needed.

All admin pages live in `/admin/`; one web-server login protects the folder, its APIs, Install Check and Health Check, and the PHP refuses the station-acting endpoints unless that login was checked.

7. The Shared Navigation & Day/Night Theme

Every page loads the same menu from `_nav.html` (through `bpq-nav-loader.js`): **BPQ Dashboard** (home), 13 page links (RF, Traffic, System, Connects, Messages, Email, Weather, Chat, APRS, VARA, Telnet, Rig, RF Power), **Guide** (the User Guide PDF), the **Admin** menu (Maintenance, Firewall, Logs, Audit), the UTC and local clocks and the (moon)/(sun) theme button; on the admin pages also **(gear)** (Dashboard Settings, §10.2). On phones the links fold behind (menu). The installer removes the Rig and RF Power links when flrig is skipped.

The theme follows the device's light/dark setting until you choose; the choice is kept per browser (`bpq-dark-mode`). The Telnet and VARA terminal areas and the RF Power meter stay dark on purpose.

> ***After changing the menu:*** *browsers cache it. Raise* `NAV_VERSION` *in* `bpq-nav-loader.js` *and the* `?v=` *on every page's* `bpq-nav-loader.js` *script tag to the same value (System Audit flags pages that differ); users then see the change after one Ctrl+Shift+R. The Guide link names the PDF file, so update it with each version.*

8. YAPP File Transfer

YAPP (Yet Another Packet Protocol) is a file transfer protocol used by BBS networks to move binary files over packet radio. The dashboard now supports YAPP directly in the browser via the **Telnet Client** page.

How to receive a file

1. Open the **Telnet Client** page, click **BPQ Node** in the sidebar and log in at BPQ's `user:` / `password:` prompts
2. Click the **Files** button under the terminal, next to **Send** ↵ (it's active once you're connected)
3. Click **Switch to file-transfer mode**. It reconnects on the FBB port (`FBBPORT=` in `bpq32.cfg`, 8011 by default) with the login you just typed, enters the BBS and lists its files. *(YAPP needs the FBB port because it's a binary protocol; the standard telnet port changes some bytes.)*
4. **Click any file** in the list. The dashboard arms the receiver and types `YAPP <filename>` for you
5. The progress bar shows speed and time left
6. When complete, click **Save** to save the file. Recent downloads stay listed in the panel

How to send a file

1. Switch to file-transfer mode as above (you're at the BBS prompt)
2. **Upload to BBS** tab → drop a file on the box or click to choose one (10 MB cap)
3. Click **Send to BBS**. There's no command to type: a BPQ BBS recognises the upload by itself and saves it in its `Files` folder. The panel warns first if the BBS already has a file of that name (BPQ won't overwrite it) and shows BPQ's message if it refuses
4. After the data is handed to the node, the panel shows *waiting for the BBS to confirm* while it goes out on air

Where files are stored

Received files land in `/var/www/bpq-dashboard/yapp-files/` on the server with the **real filename from the YAPP header**, prefixed by a timestamp (e.g. `20260524-191234-update-bpq`).

The System Audit page reports the folder's size and warns from 500 MB.

For cleanup:

```
# Delete YAPP files older than 30 days
find /var/www/bpq-dashboard/yapp-files/ -mtime +30 -type f -delete
```

Troubleshooting YAPP

The file list is empty or says you're at the node prompt — enter the BBS first (the panel's *Enter BBS* link, or type `BBS`), then list the files again.

File-transfer mode says the login was refused — it uses the BPQ user name and password you typed in that tab (or the ones you enter in the panel), not `config.php`. Check them against your `USER=` line in `bpq32.cfg`.

Transfer stops — a transfer is stopped only when nothing at all arrives for 2 minutes (an upload also allows for the file's time on air while the BBS confirms). If that happens the link has dropped or is too poor.

Upload refused — BPQ won't overwrite an existing file, and has its own size limit; the panel shows BPQ's message.

Received files whose names could run on the web server (`.php`, `.html`, `.svg`, `.js` …) are stored as `name_ext.bin`; the Save link restores the original name. The folder is behind the admin login.

9. VARA HF Terminal Setup

The VARA HF Terminal lets you make keyboard-to-keyboard HF radio connections from your browser.

Requirements

- VARA HF modem software running (Windows PC connected to your radio, or Wine on Linux)
- flrig running and connected to the radio (on this server or another computer; `radio` in `config.php`)
- A VARA HF port in `bpq32.cfg` (`DRIVER=VARA`)
- An FLRIG `RADIO 2` block in `bpq32.cfg`: the page retunes by rewriting that block (frequency changes and the End Session restore currently handle `RADIO 2` only), and `www-data` must be able to write `bpq32.cfg`
- The `bpq-vara` service running (`sudo systemctl enable --now bpq-vara`); the installer's site file passes its `/ws/vara` connection through, behind the admin login

Configure the service

The service reads `config.php` (through `scripts/print-bbs-config.php`, like the chat service):

Setting in `config.php`	Used for	Default
`bbs` host, port, user, pass	BPQ telnet login. Use a BPQ user whose default application is the BBS: the service goes BBS → `NODE` → `ATT`, and a user that lands straight at the node may not be allowed to `ATT`	—

Setting in `config.php`	Used for	Default
`vara.bpq_port`	BPQ port number of the VARA HF port	`0` = the first `DRIVER=VARA` port in `bpq32.cfg` that isn't VARA FM (its `PORTNUM=`, or its position)
`vara.user`, `vara.pass`	A different BPQ login just for the VARA terminal	unset = the `bbs` login

```
sudo systemctl restart bpq-vara
sudo journalctl -u bpq-vara -n 5      # "BPQ telnet … as <user>; VARA HF = BPQ port N (from …)"
```

If the login isn't set or no VARA port is found, the service stops at start-up with a `FATAL:` line saying what to set.

The page's own login is `bbs.pass` from `config.php`. *Request access* on the login box (and on the Chat page) has the server e-mail `station.email`; the address isn't shown to visitors. That needs a working mail setup on the server (PHP `mail()`, e.g. a sendmail-compatible relay); with none, or with `station.email` empty or an `example.com` address, the page says the request couldn't be sent. One request per address every 10 minutes (`cache/access-requests.json`).

Using the VARA HF Terminal

See the User Guide, Section 7: five quick-frequency buttons (fixed in this release), any other frequency typed in MHz (ITU Region 2 data bands only; set when you press Connect), bandwidth BW500/BW2300/BW2750, **D** to drop the link and keep the port, **End Session** to release the port and restore the scan schedule.

9b. Supported Radios — flrig Profiles

BPQ Dashboard communicates with your radio through flrig, which acts as a universal bridge. This means it works with Yaesu, Icom, Kenwood, Elecraft, and other radios without hardware-specific code.

When the VARA HF Terminal or Rig Status page starts, the server asks flrig for the radio's name (`rig.get_xcvr`) to automatically detect your radio model. You can also force a specific profile by setting `model` in the `radio` section of config.php.

Built-in profiles (each sets the right data mode for VARA): **Yaesu** FTdx3000, FTdx10, FTdx101, FT-991, FT-710, FT-891, FT-450, FT-897, FT-857 · **Icom** IC-7300, IC-7610, IC-705, IC-7100, IC-7600, IC-7700, IC-7800, IC-9700, IC-7200 · **Kenwood** TS-590, TS-890, TS-2000 · **Elecraft** K3, KX3, K4. Matching ignores case, dashes and spaces and takes the longest name that fits, so an FTdx101D uses the FTdx101 profile, a K3S the K3, an IC-7300MK2 the IC-7300 and an FT-991A the FT-991. A radio with no profile still shows frequency, power and SWR; the dashboard just never switches its mode. Power, SWR and S-meter readings work whichever reply format your radio's flrig driver uses.

> ***Important:*** *flrig must be running and showing your radio model in its title bar AND actively reading frequency before the dashboard can use it. Without flrig, the Rig Status page shows offline and the VARA HF Terminal can't QSY.*
>
> ***Installer note:*** `install.sh` *(Step 9) installs and configures flrig for you — either locally with a systemd service (flrig has no native headless mode, so this runs it under Xvfb) if the radio is connected to the same machine, or just records the host/port if flrig runs elsewhere. Either way, one manual step remains: on a local install, you still need to pick your radio model and confirm it's reading frequency via flrig's own GUI once (over* `ssh -X`*) before the unattended service can use it — the installer prints the exact steps at*

the end of that step.

10. Optional Features

10.1 Connect Watchdog

`scripts/connect-watchdog.py` watches the BBS log for repeated failed outgoing forwarding connects. When a partner fails 3 times within 3 hours, it replaces that partner's ConnectScript in `linmail.cfg` with a pause, and puts the original back after 4 hours, restarting LinBPQ each time so it loads the change (`systemctl stop bpq` / `start bpq`; set `bpq_stop_cmd` / `bpq_start_cmd` in its `CONFIG` if your service has another name). State is kept in `cache/watchdog-state.json`; its log is `connect-watchdog.log` in the logs folder.

Set up:

1. Edit the `PARTNERS` dict near the top of the script: one entry per partner, with the `connect_call` that appears in your ConnectScript (e.g. `W1XYZ-1`) and its `attach_port`. The detection settings (`fail_threshold`, `fail_window_mins`, `pause_hours`) are in `CONFIG` just above.
2. It edits `linmail.cfg` (found through `config.php` `paths.linbpq`) and restarts LinBPQ, so run it as root from root's crontab:

```
*/5 * * * * /usr/bin/python3 /var/www/bpq-dashboard/scripts/connect-watchdog.py
```

10.2 Propagation Scheduler

`scripts/prop-scheduler.py` rewrites your HF forwarding partners' ConnectScripts in `linmail.cfg` from current conditions (NOAA K-index and solar flux), your connection history and time-of-day band models, restarts LinBPQ (`systemctl stop bpq` / `start bpq`) to load them, and sends you a report as a BBS message.

- **Partners:** `data/partners.json` — edit it on the Maintenance page (*Forwarding partners editor*; BBS password). The `PARTNERS` dict in the script is only the fallback when that file is empty.
- **Its own settings** (home position, the BBS login for the report, scoring weights, the LinBPQ service commands) are in the `CONFIG` dict at the top of the script, or in `data/settings.json`, which overrides it. Edit `settings.json` with **(gear) Dashboard Settings** on any admin page (BBS password; User Guide §19). **Save All** writes every tab, so fill in Station and BBS first. Partners listed there replace `data/partners.json`.
- **Database:** read like the log parsers — `db-config.php`, else `config.php` `db` (or `BPQ_DB_*` environment variables). Paths follow the install folder and `config.php` `paths`.
- Try it without changes first: `sudo python3 /var/www/bpq-dashboard/scripts/prop-scheduler.py` (a dry run). `--apply` writes `linmail.cfg`; the previous copy goes to `scripts/prop-backups/`. As with the watchdog, the LinBPQ service commands are in `CONFIG`.

Schedule it in root's crontab (it edits `linmail.cfg` and restarts LinBPQ):

```
0 6 */2 * * /usr/bin/python3 /var/www/bpq-dashboard/scripts/prop-scheduler.py --apply >> /var/log/bpq-dash
```

Optional decision history: the installer loads the `prop_decisions` table, where the scheduler records each decision (time, Kp/SFI, band). For a manual install: `sudo mysql bpqdash < /var/www/bpq-dashboard/data/prop-decisions-schema.sql`.

10.3 Storm Monitor

`scripts/storm-monitor.py` is the fast companion to the scheduler: every hour it checks the planetary K-index and, when a geomagnetic storm builds, moves all HF forwarding partners to 80 m (and suspends a partner entirely above its `suspend_kp`). When conditions recover it restores the scheduler's ConnectScripts. It reads the same `data/partners.json`; its own settings are in the script's `CONFIG` or (gear) Dashboard Settings (*Storm Mon* tab, `data/settings.json`), as for the scheduler.

```
sudo python3 /var/www/bpq-dashboard/scripts/storm-monitor.py --status    # current Kp and state
sudo python3 /var/www/bpq-dashboard/scripts/storm-monitor.py --restore   # put normal schedules back
```

Root's crontab:

```
0 * * * * /usr/bin/python3 /var/www/bpq-dashboard/scripts/storm-monitor.py >> /var/log/bpq-dashboard/storm
```

It doesn't post weather bulletins; NWS posting is done from the NWS page (§10.4).

10.4 NWS Weather Alerts

The NWS page needs no setup to show alerts: it reads api.weather.gov directly in the browser. Posting an alert to your BBS (**Post to BBS**, **Post All**) goes through `nws-bbs-post.php`, which uses:

- the `bbs` login and `station.callsign` from `config.php`;
- the page's **BBS Destination** box, which starts as `'nws' => ['post_destination' => …]` from `config.php` — if that's empty, `WX@<nws.auto_post.area>`, otherwise `WX@ALLUS`. An address starting with a callsign is sent as a private message (`SP`), anything else (e.g. `WX@GA`) as a bulletin (`SB`) that floods to the BBSs carrying it;
- `features.nws_post` (on by default; forced off in public mode);
- the admin login.

Posts are logged in `/var/log/bpq-dashboard/dashboard.log` (Log Viewer → *Dashboard log*; `logs/dashboard.log` before v1.5.19). `nws-config.php.example` is left over from an older version and isn't read.

Automatic posting (optional). `scripts/nws-auto-post.php`, run every 5 minutes by `nws-auto-post.timer`, posts new Warnings and Watches for one state as bulletins (`SB`, through the Email Client's send code and BBS lock). It posts the **first issue** of each alert only (no updates, extensions or cancellations), skips anything that has already ended, never posts the same alert twice (`cache/nws-auto-post-state.json`), and combines a watch that several NWS offices each issued into one bulletin (waiting `watch_hold_minutes` for their pieces). Settings are `'nws' => ['auto_post' => [...]]` in `config.php` (see `config.php.example`); nothing posts until `enabled` is `true` and `area` is a state code. It does not depend on `features.nws_post` or public mode.

The installer asks whether to turn it on, and for your state, the bulletin address and which alerts. It always installs the timer's unit files, and starts the timer only if you said Yes.

Setting	Installer default	Meaning
`enabled`	your answer	Nothing posts until `true` (`--dry-run` and `--seed` still work).
`area`	your state	2-letter state or territory code whose alerts are read.

Setting	Installer default	Meaning
`destination`	`WX@` + state	Bulletin address. Empty = `WX@<area>`. Use a flood area your forwarding partners carry, or the bulletins stay on your BBS.
`events`	`['Warning', 'Watch']`	Event names ending in these. `['Warning']` = warnings only.
`exclude`	`[]`	Exact event names never posted, e.g. `['Red Flag Warning', 'Freeze Warning']`.
`watch_hold_minutes`	`10`	Wait for the other NWS offices' pieces of a watch before posting it. `0` = no wait.
`max_per_run`	`10`	Upper limit per 5-minute run; the rest go out on the next run.
`timezone`	your state's main zone	Time zone of the times printed in the bulletins.

To turn it on later (or after an upgrade), set `'enabled' => true` and `'area' => 'XX'` in `config.php`. Check what it would post now (`--dry-run` posts and records nothing):

```
sudo -u www-data php /var/www/bpq-dashboard/scripts/nws-auto-post.php --dry-run
```

Optionally, mark the alerts already in force as posted, so only new ones go out:

```
sudo -u www-data php /var/www/bpq-dashboard/scripts/nws-auto-post.php --seed
```

Start the timer. The first two lines copy its unit files only if the installer didn't (older installs):

```
cd /etc/systemd/system
[ -f nws-auto-post.timer ] || sudo cp /var/www/bpq-dashboard/nws-auto-post.{service,timer} .
sudo systemctl daemon-reload
sudo systemctl enable --now nws-auto-post.timer
journalctl -u nws-auto-post -n 20 --no-pager
```

The journal shows one summary line per run. (If your web root is not `/var/www/bpq-dashboard`, use yours in these commands and in the `ExecStart=` line of `/etc/systemd/system/nws-auto-post.service`.) To stop it: `'enabled' => false`, or `sudo systemctl disable --now nws-auto-post.timer`.

"Warning" includes the less urgent ones too (Flood, Freeze, Wind, Heat, Red Flag, Winter Storm …); add any that are too chatty to `exclude`. The NWS page doesn't know what the timer has posted, so don't post the same alerts by hand. System Audit shows a row for the timer when it is switched on.

Log: `logs/nws-auto-post.log` (Log Viewer → *NWS auto-post*).

10.5 RF Power Monitor (FLRIG-based)

Reads power and SWR from your radio through flrig — the same connection Rig Status uses. No separate wattmeter, no file copying from another machine.

The history is written by the `rig-history-poller` service to `rig-history.jsonl` in `paths.datalog` (default the logs folder), kept 30 days: about one sample a minute when idle and every 3 seconds while transmitting. flrig reports SWR but not reflected power, so reflected watts are calculated from SWR and forward power. Watt-hours always read 0 (flrig has no energy reading). See `RF-POWER-MONITOR-MIGRATION.md` for the move from the old WaveNode-based version.

10.6 Data Archival

`scripts/archive-bpq-data.sh` copies BPQ's logs and the dashboard's `data/` folder into `archives/`: a 7-day archive each week (12 kept) and, in the first week of each month, a full archive of the previous month (12 kept). It only makes copies. Its default folder is an old path, so pass yours:

```
0 2 * * 0 DASHBOARD_DIR=/var/www/bpq-dashboard /var/www/bpq-dashboard/scripts/archive-bpq-data.sh >> /var/
```

10.7 PTT Indicator and Remote Power Control

Rig Status always shows PTT (receive, transmit). It can also switch a network power switch for the radio (written for a Synaccess NP-05B-style switch). Fill in the `smartplug` section of `config.php` (it's in `config.php.example`; on an older `config.php`, add it inside `return [ … ];`):

```
'smartplug' => [
    'host'   => '192.168.1.60',
    'user'   => 'admin',
    'pass'   => 'secret',
    'outlet' => 1,
],
```

With `host` empty, or no section at all, the outlet card shows **Not set up** and nothing is contacted (versions before 2026-10-27 tried `192.168.1.100` with `admin`/`admin`; if your switch really is there with those settings, write them into the section). **Power OFF** and **Reboot** are refused while the radio is transmitting.

The same (lock) unlock (the BBS password) also enables the **TX Power** card: a slider, a number box and presets set the radio's power through flrig (`rig.set_power`). The range is the radio's own, limited by `radio.max_power` / `radio.min_power` when set. Each change is written to the PHP error log with the requesting address.

10.8 RF Connections database optimization (recommended)

> ***Already done if you used*** `install.sh`***:*** *it loads the schema and schedules the parser (*`/etc/cron.d/bpq-dashboard`*). The steps below are for manual installs and for background.*

>

> ***Strongly recommended*** *— makes the RF Connections page load in under a second instead of several seconds. Required if you want to use the Phase 1 fast path.*

The RF Connections page can either parse your VARA log file on every page load (the legacy fallback) or read pre-digested session records from a MySQL/MariaDB table (the fast path). The fast path requires:

1. MariaDB/MySQL installed and the `bpqdash` database (section 4, Part B step 2)
2. The `rf_connections` schema applied (one-time)
3. A cron job that runs `parse-vara-log.py` every few minutes to keep the table fresh

One-time setup:

```
# 1. Apply the schema and its updates (rf_connections, rf_parser_state, rf_messages)
sudo mysql bpqdash < /var/www/bpq-dashboard/data/rf-connections-schema.sql
for f in 2026-09-21-rf-messages-medium 2026-10-06-rf-messages-delivery; do sudo mysql bpqdash < sql/$f.sql

# 2. Install pymysql for the parser
sudo apt install -y python3-pymysql

# 3. Initial backfill — walks the entire VARA log once
```

```
sudo -u www-data python3 /var/www/bpq-dashboard/scripts/parse-vara-log.py --bbs-log-dir /var/www/bpq-dashb

# 4. Verify the table populated
sudo mysql bpqdash -e "SELECT COUNT(*) AS sessions FROM rf_connections"
```

Schedule incremental updates: the parser line in `/etc/cron.d/bpq-dashboard` (Section 4, Part B, step 8). Its log is `/var/log/bpq-dashboard/parse-vara-log.log`. `--bbs-log-dir` and `--my-callsign` matter: without them forwarded messages and frequencies aren't picked up.

Verify the fast path is active:

After hard-refreshing the RF Connections page, the status pill in the upper right should read:

> *[OK] **N connections (DB)***

The **(DB)** suffix confirms the page is using the database. If you see only "N connections" without it, the page fell back to reading the log files in the browser — check the parser log and the browser console for `[RF API]` messages.

For more detail, troubleshooting, and rollback procedures, see `docs/PHASE-1-DEPLOYMENT.md`.

> ***Note:** The parser user needs `SELECT/INSERT/UPDATE/DELETE` privileges on the `bpqdash` database — standard CRUD, no need for DROP or ALTER. The `bpqdash` user created by the installer (or in section 4, Part B step 2) has all required grants.*

10.9 VARA HF Callsign Validator

A transparent TCP proxy that sits between BPQ32 and your VARA HF modem to **reject malformed or unauthorized callsigns before BPQ32 ever sees the session**. Useful if you operate a public-facing gateway and want to protect your BBS from connection attempts from invalid or unlicensed callsigns.

Architecture:

```
VARA HF (Windows or Wine)  e.g. 127.0.0.1:8300/8301
         ^  validator forwards here after callsign check
[validator] listening on 127.0.0.1:9025/9026  (config.php)
         ^  BPQ32 connects to validator instead of VARA directly
BPQ32 (Linux)
```

Validation rules:

- ITU Radio Regulations Appendix 42 callsign format (prefix, digit, suffix; SSID and /portable removed first)
- an allow list (always accepted) and a deny list (always refused, default `NOCALL TEST N0CALL INVALID`)

Install (v1.5.19: the installer's page question *VARA callsign check* does steps 1–2; it runs as the web user from the dashboard folder and logs to `/var/log/bpq-dashboard/vara-validator.log`):

```
# 1. Settings: config.php
sudo nano /var/www/bpq-dashboard/config.php
#   'vara_validator' => [
#       'vara_host'       => '127.0.0.1',  // where VARA HF listens (its command port; data = +1)
#       'vara_cmd_port'   => 8300,
#       'listen_host'     => '127.0.0.1',  // where BPQ connects ('0.0.0.0' only if BPQ is on another mach
#       'listen_cmd_port' => 9025,         // data = 9026
#       'allow' => [], 'deny' => ['NOCALL', 'TEST', 'N0CALL', 'INVALID'],
#   ],
#   and 'pages' => ['vara_validator' => true, ...]

# 2. The service
```

```
sed 's|/var/www/bpq-dashboard|/var/www/bpq-dashboard|g' /var/www/bpq-dashboard/vara-validator.service \
  | sudo tee /etc/systemd/system/vara-validator.service >/dev/null
sudo systemctl daemon-reload
sudo systemctl enable --now vara-validator

# 3. Point BPQ32 at the validator instead of VARA directly:
#    In bpq32.cfg, the VARA port's ADDR line becomes 127.0.0.1 9025
#    (listen_host / listen_cmd_port) instead of VARA HF's own address.

# 4. Restart LinBPQ (your service name, e.g. bpq or linbpq) to pick up the new target.
sudo systemctl restart bpq
```

Before v1.5.19 the unit said `User=pi` and `/usr/local/bin/vara-callsign-validator.py`, and the settings were inside the script; copy any you changed into `config.php`, install the new unit, and delete the old copy in `/usr/local/bin`.

Verify:

```
ss -tlnp | grep -E ':902[56]\b'                                    # listening
sudo tail -f /var/log/bpq-dashboard/vara-validator.log             # verdicts (Log Viewer > VARA Validator)
```

Each incoming connection logs `ACCEPTED` or `REJECTED` with the callsign and the reason; a rejected one is dropped before BPQ32 receives a CONNECT event.

10.10 Winlink White Pages cleanup tools

Two scripts for maintaining a clean Winlink White Pages database (`WP.cfg`):

- `wp_scanner.py` — read-only scan that reports bogus, invalid, or stale entries
- `wp_manager.py` — interactive workflow to safely remove flagged entries while preserving R-numbers (so Winlink/BPQ32 internal references stay intact)

Manual workflow:

```
# 1. Scan and produce a review file
python3 /var/www/bpq-dashboard/scripts/wp_manager.py --scan

# 2. Edit wp_review.txt — change "?" to REMOVE or KEEP for each entry

# 3. Apply your decisions
python3 /var/www/bpq-dashboard/scripts/wp_manager.py --apply

# 4. Check for changes after the next WP sync
python3 /var/www/bpq-dashboard/scripts/wp_manager.py --diff
```

Automated cleanup via cron (only removes entries with obvious format errors, never stale-but-valid ones):

```
# Edit www-data's crontab
sudo crontab -u www-data -e

# Add: daily auto-clean at 03:00 UTC
0 3 * * * cd /opt/linbpq && python3 /var/www/bpq-dashboard/scripts/wp_manager.py --auto-clean >> /var/log/
```

Use your LinBPQ folder in the `cd` *(the script works on* `WP.cfg` *there, or pass* `--wp /path/WP.cfg`*).*
Caution: *run* `--auto-clean --dry-run` *first to preview what would be removed. Bogus auto-cleanup of valid entries could break Winlink message routing.*

10.11 VARA log collection

RF Connections is built from VARA HF's session log (… `VARAHF <CALL> connected VARA HF`, bitrate and S/N lines). It travels like this:

VARA HF (Syslog on) → UDP 514 → **rsyslog** on this server → `/var/log/syslog` → `vara-logger` → `logs/<callsign>.vara` → `parse-vara-log.py` (every 5 minutes) → the database → RF Connections.

If you answered Yes to the installer's VARA HF log question, the server side is done: rsyslog is installed and accepts UDP 514 from the VARA computer only (`/etc/rsyslog.d/10-bpq-dashboard-vara.conf`), ufw (if active) lets that address in, and `vara-logger` is running. Do step 1 below in VARA HF, then the test in step 5.

1. VARA HF — send the log. Syslog is in the **registered (paid) version** of VARA HF. In VARA HF: **Settings** → **VARA Setup**:

Setting	Value
Syslog	ticked
Syslog Host	this server's IP address (e.g. `192.168.1.10`); `localhost` only if VARA runs on this server
UDP Port	`514`
Station Name	`H-` + your VARA call-SSID, e.g. `H-W1AW-7`. RF Connections looks for lines from `H-…`, so keep the `H-`

Give the VARA computer a fixed address (a DHCP reservation in your router): the receiver only accepts that address.

2. rsyslog — receive it (by hand; the installer does this). Debian 12 doesn't install rsyslog, so:

```
sudo apt install -y rsyslog
grep -rn imudp /etc/rsyslog.conf /etc/rsyslog.d/ | grep -v ':#'
```

If the `grep` prints nothing (only commented-out `#` lines exist), create the receiver (replace `192.168.1.50` with the VARA computer's address):

```
sudo tee /etc/rsyslog.d/10-bpq-dashboard-vara.conf >/dev/null <<'EOF'
# BPQ Dashboard: receive VARA HF's syslog on UDP 514, from these senders only
$AllowedSender UDP, 127.0.0.1, 192.168.1.50
module(load="imudp")
input(type="imudp" port="514")
EOF
sudo rsyslogd -N1 && sudo systemctl restart rsyslog
ss -uln | grep ':514 '
```

`rsyslogd -N1` must end with "End of config validation run"; `ss` shows `0.0.0.0:514`. If the `grep` printed a line, UDP reception is already on: don't add a second receiver: add the VARA computer to that receiver's allowed senders instead.

3. Firewall — let only the VARA computer in:

```
sudo ufw allow from 192.168.1.50 to any port 514 proto udp comment 'VARA HF syslog'
```

(Other firewalls: allow UDP 514 from that address only. Never open 514 to the internet.)

4. vara-logger — keep the lines. `vara-logger.sh` copies every new `VARAHF` line from `/var/log/syslog` into `logs/<callsign>.vara` (`logs.vara_file` in `config.php`), a file that survives log rotation. rsyslog on Debian 12 and Ubuntu 24.04 writes timestamps like `2026-10-27T13:15:48-04:00`; vara-logger rewrites

them to the `Oct 27 13:15:48` form the parsers read. The installer sets the file name and installs the service; by hand:

```
sudo nano /var/www/bpq-dashboard/vara-logger.sh        # set OUTPUT_FILE to …/logs/<yourcall>.vara
sudo cp /var/www/bpq-dashboard/vara-logger.service /etc/systemd/system/
sudo systemctl daemon-reload
sudo systemctl enable --now vara-logger
```

5. Test.

```
logger -n 127.0.0.1 -P 514 -d -t VARATEST "receiver test"; sleep 1; grep VARATEST /var/log/syslog | tail -
```

shows the test line (rsyslog works; the `VARATEST` tag keeps it out of the VARA log). Then make or receive a VARA HF connection:

```
grep VARAHF /var/log/syslog | tail -3                  # arrived from VARA
tail -3 /var/www/bpq-dashboard/logs/<yourcall>.vara    # kept by vara-logger
```

The lines start with the time and `H-<your call-SSID> VARAHF`. Within 5 minutes the session is on RF Connections. Install Check's *VARA HF log* rows show the receiver and when the last line arrived.

If nothing arrives: VARA's Syslog box ticked and the Host/port right; the VARA computer's address is the one allowed (rsyslog and firewall); a Windows firewall on the VARA computer isn't blocking outgoing UDP 514; `sudo systemctl status rsyslog vara-logger`.

TPRFN stations: the log from the TPRFN server (v1.5.19). If your VARA HF sends its syslog to the TPRFN server instead of this machine, the server keeps a copy for your station (`https://<TPRFN server>/<call>.vara`; the TPRFN server admin sets it up and gives you the address) and the dashboard downloads it. No receiver, rsyslog rule or vara-logger here. The installer does this when you choose **2** at the VARA log question; by hand:

```
sudo nano /var/www/bpq-dashboard/config.php
#   'vara_remote' => ['enabled' => true, 'url' => 'https://<TPRFN server>/w1aw.vara'],
#   'logs'        => ['vara_file' => '/var/log/bpq-dashboard/w1aw.vara'],
W=/var/www/bpq-dashboard
sed "s|/var/www/bpq-dashboard|$W|g" $W/vara-remote.service | sudo tee /etc/systemd/system/vara-remote.serv
sudo cp $W/vara-remote.timer /etc/systemd/system/
sudo systemctl daemon-reload && sudo systemctl enable --now vara-remote.timer
sudo -u www-data python3 $W/scripts/fetch-vara-remote.py -v      # test now
```

Every 5 minutes (at :03, :08 …, two minutes after the server rebuilds the file) it fetches only the new part, writes through a temporary file and keeps the last good copy if the server can't be reached; if the server's file got shorter it fetches it all again. It sends a `BPQ-Dashboard/<version> (<CALL>)` user agent (the server's bot filter refuses plain curl). Log: `/var/log/bpq-dashboard/vara-remote.log` (Log Viewer → VARA download); Install Check and System Audit show the last good download. *HTTP 404* = no file for your call on the server yet.

10.12 NetROM RTT collection

`nodes-rtt.sh` (in the dashboard folder) logs in to the node, runs `n t` and writes the NetROM nodes with their round-trip times to `logs/nodesrtt.txt`. `parse-system-logs.py` loads it; System Logs shows the RTT on the *Internet Connected Stations* tiles.

```
sudo apt install -y expect
sudo nano /var/www/bpq-dashboard/nodes-rtt.sh
# Set TELNET_HOST, TELNET_PORT, TELNET_USER, TELNET_PASS and OUTPUT_FILE
sudo chmod 700 /var/www/bpq-dashboard/nodes-rtt.sh      # it holds a password
```

It writes into the LinBPQ logs folder (through the `logs` link), so run it as a user that may write there, e.g. root's crontab:

```
*/10 * * * * /var/www/bpq-dashboard/nodes-rtt.sh
```

11. Security Hardening

> ***Important:*** *Do not skip this section if your server is accessible from the internet.*

Admin login (required) and LAN-only (optional)

Everything in `/admin/`, `install-check.php` and `health-check.php` must ask for the admin login. Check it from any machine (each line should print `401`):

```
for u in /admin/bpq-maintenance.html "/admin/partners-api.php?action=validate" /install-check.php /health-
  curl -s -o /dev/null -w "%{http_code}  $u\n" -A 'Mozilla/5.0' "https://YOUR_HOST$u"
done
```

`install.sh` and `bpq-dashboard.conf` set this up with one `location ^~ /admin/` block. If several site names (server blocks) share the same web root, each one needs it, or a redirect to the protected one. Before v1.5.13 the templates protected only the old top-level page names, which no longer exist, so re-check older installs. The Maintenance page also shows the result at the top every time it opens.

To **also** allow the admin pages only from your home network, add `allow`/`deny` lines inside that same `/admin/` block. `nginx-maintenance-block.conf` shows where. Don't add a second `/admin/` block.

```
location ^~ /admin/ {
    auth_basic           "YOURCALL Admin";
    auth_basic_user_file /etc/nginx/.bpq-mgmt-auth;
    allow 10.0.0.0/8;
    allow 192.168.0.0/16;
    allow 127.0.0.1;
    deny all;
    # ... the existing nested PHP block and try_files stay as they are
}
```

Then: `sudo nginx -t && sudo systemctl reload nginx && echo RELOADED`. Check that `RELOADED` prints: until nginx reloads, it keeps using the old rules even though the file has changed.

HTTPS and the firewall (IPv6 too)

If the dashboard can be reached from outside your home network:

1. **Use HTTPS**, so the login and your mail aren't sent in clear text: `sudo certbot --nginx -d your.domain`.
2. **Check the firewall for IPv4 and IPv6.** Many home connections now give the server a public IPv6 address that bypasses the router's port forwarding, and LinBPQ listens on every address by default. Only 80/443, and anything you mean to share such as forwarding ports, should be open:

   ```
   sudo iptables -S INPUT | head -3
   sudo ip6tables -S INPUT | head -3      # policy should be DROP, not ACCEPT
   sudo ss -tlnp | grep -E 'linbpq|:80 |:443 '
   ```

3. Read `SECURITY.md` (in the dashboard folder). It lists everything that matters for running the dashboard safely and how to report a security problem.

No firewall yet? (v1.5.19) `tools/setup-firewall.sh` sets up ufw for a packet station. It asks: your home network (detected, you confirm it), SSH from home only or anywhere, the dashboard from home only or anywhere, BPQ telnet/FBB from home only or anywhere (for forwarding partners who connect in). BPQ's web-management port stays home-only; VARA HF's syslog (UDP 514, from the VARA computer) and BPQ AXIP/AXUDP ports from `bpq32.cfg` are added by themselves. The address of the SSH session you run it from is always allowed, so you can't lock yourself out. It shows every rule and asks again before switching ufw on, and offers fail2ban. On a server where ufw is already on, it only adds the rules that are missing.

```
sudo bash /var/www/bpq-dashboard/tools/setup-firewall.sh --dry-run   # questions + the rules, nothing char
sudo bash /var/www/bpq-dashboard/tools/setup-firewall.sh             # the real run
sudo ufw status numbered                                             # check;  undo: sudo ufw disable  (or
```

The installer offers it as its last step (default No).

Protect the data directory (Apache only)

The nginx configuration from the installer already refuses `/data/`. On Apache:

```
echo "deny from all" | sudo tee /var/www/bpq-dashboard/data/.htaccess
```

Change default passwords

- Linux user password: `passwd`
- BPQ BBS password — change in bpq32.cfg AND update config.php to match
- Dashboard admin login (Email Client, Chat, admin pages, Install Check, Health Check) — Maintenance → *Admin login* → **Change admin password** (v1.5.19), or over SSH `sudo htpasswd -B /etc/nginx/.bpq-mgmt-auth admin` (use your admin user name; it asks for the new password)

Configure sudoers for www-data

The Firewall Status and System Audit pages need read-only access to a few system commands. The package has the rules ready in `www-data-tools.sudoers`:

```
sudo cp /var/www/bpq-dashboard/www-data-tools.sudoers /etc/sudoers.d/www-data-tools
sudo chmod 440 /etc/sudoers.d/www-data-tools
sudo visudo -c
```

It allows exactly these commands, with exactly these arguments, and nothing else:

```
www-data ALL=(root) NOPASSWD: /usr/sbin/iptables -L -n --line-numbers -v
www-data ALL=(root) NOPASSWD: /usr/sbin/ip6tables -L -n --line-numbers -v
www-data ALL=(root) NOPASSWD: /usr/bin/fail2ban-client status
www-data ALL=(root) NOPASSWD: /usr/bin/fail2ban-client status *
www-data ALL=(root) NOPASSWD: /usr/bin/ss -tlnp
www-data ALL=(root) NOPASSWD: /usr/sbin/nginx -t
```

v1.5.19 adds one rule that changes something: the Maintenance page's *Change admin password*. It may only run a small root-owned helper, which changes the password of an admin login already in `/etc/nginx/.bpq-mgmt-auth` (password on stdin, never logged):

```
www-data ALL=(root) NOPASSWD: /usr/local/sbin/bpq-dashboard-set-admin-password *
```

The helper must be a root-owned copy outside the web folder (the web user can write in the web folder, so a sudo rule pointing there would hand it root):

```
sudo install -o root -g root -m 755 /var/www/bpq-dashboard/tools/set-admin-password /usr/local/sbin/bpq-da
```

Without the helper or the rule, the page says so and shows the `htpasswd` command instead.

> *Both* `status` *and* `status *` *lines are needed: in sudoers* `*` *needs at least one argument, so it doesn't cover bare* `status` *(the jail list).*
>
> *Paths are Debian / Ubuntu's;* `command -v iptables ip6tables fail2ban-client ss nginx` *shows yours. A sudo rule must match the command exactly, so after an upgrade copy the file again (the 2026-10-25 version replaced rules that no longer matched what the pages run).*

The pages run these with `sudo -n`, so a missing rule never hangs a page: the row says what it couldn't check and shows the command above. Everything else on both pages works without sudo.

Public-mode

If the dashboard will be internet-facing, set in config.php:

```
'security_mode' => 'public',
```

This turns off everything that writes to the BBS (Send, Forward, Kill in the Email Client, and NWS posting), turns on the dashboard's own rate limiting and keeps CORS same-origin. It doesn't replace the admin login; keep that on everything that acts as your station.

12. Troubleshooting

When something stops working, always start with the **System Audit** page (`/admin/system-audit.html`). It diagnoses most problems automatically.

Page won't load — "This site can't be reached"

nginx is not running or has a configuration error.

```
sudo systemctl status nginx
sudo systemctl start nginx
sudo nginx -t
sudo journalctl -u nginx -n 30
```

502 Bad Gateway

nginx can't reach PHP: either PHP-FPM is not running, or the site file points at a socket that doesn't exist.

```
systemctl list-units 'php*-fpm*'          # shows your version, e.g. php8.5-fpm
sudo systemctl restart php8.5-fpm         # use the name shown above
ls -l /run/php/                           # the socket PHP really listens on
sudo grep -n fastcgi_pass /etc/nginx/sites-enabled/*
```

Every `fastcgi_pass` line must name a socket that `ls` shows, with its version number (`php8.5-fpm.sock`). Installers before 2026-10-30 could write the generic `/run/php/php-fpm.sock`, which doesn't exist on some systems (seen on Ubuntu with PHP 8.5). Fix it with your version:

```
SITE=/etc/nginx/sites-enabled/bpq-dashboard
sudo sed -i --follow-symlinks \
  's|php-fpm.sock|php8.5-fpm.sock|g' $SITE
sudo nginx -t && sudo systemctl reload nginx
```

The nginx error log shows this as `connect() to unix:/run/php/php-fpm.sock failed (2: No such file or directory)`. Install Check (*PHP-FPM socket in site config*) and System Audit flag it.

500 Internal Server Error on the admin pages (and Email Client, Chat, Install Check)

Usually the web server can't read the admin login file. The error log shows:

```
[crit] open() "/etc/nginx/.bpq-mgmt-auth" failed (13: Permission denied)
```

```
sudo tail -20 /var/log/nginx/bpq-dashboard.error.log
ls -l /etc/nginx/.bpq-mgmt-auth           # should be: -rw-r----- root www-data
sudo chown root:www-data /etc/nginx/.bpq-mgmt-auth
sudo chmod 640 /etc/nginx/.bpq-mgmt-auth
```

No reload is needed; the next request reads the file. Installers before 2026-10-30 left it `root:root` (fixed: the installer and `fix-permissions.sh` now set `root:www-data 640`). If the file is missing altogether, nginx also answers 500; create it with `sudo htpasswd -cB /etc/nginx/.bpq-mgmt-auth admin` and run the two lines above.

503 Service Temporarily Unavailable / 429 Too Many Requests

nginx's rate limiter turned the request away — PHP is fine (a PHP failure shows as 502 or 504). The sample nginx configs allow each visitor about 5 PHP requests per second plus a short burst. Older configs answer with **503**, current ones with **429**.

Confirm it and see which page and zone caused it:

```
sudo grep "limiting requests" /var/log/nginx/error.log | tail -10
```

Each line names the zone (`... by zone "dashboard_api"`), the client IP and the request. Common causes:

- **A bulk action in the Email Client** (Mark Read on a big selection, Empty folder, bulk Kill) on an older `bbs-messages.html`. Since 2026-10-19 the page paces these itself — update the page and hard-refresh (Ctrl+Shift+R).
- **Both sites sharing one rate-limit bucket** in an older two-site config, so a busy page on one site gives 503s on the other. Merge the 2026-10-19 `limit_req` changes from `bpq-dashboard.conf` (separate zone for the BPQ site, home pages on the page bucket), then `sudo nginx -t && sudo systemctl reload nginx`.
- **Several devices behind one router** count as one visitor; that is normal and rarely enough on its own.

To see who is sending the most requests:

```
sudo tail -n 20000 /var/log/nginx/access.log | awk '{print $1}' | sort | uniq -c | sort -rn | head -5
```

"JSON.parse: unexpected character" on dashboard page

PHP-FPM crashed during the request. Common causes:

- A network call inside the PHP timed out (defensive timeouts added in v1.5.12 prevent this)
- PHP-FPM hit a memory limit
- Bad sudoers configuration

```
# the installer's site logs to /var/log/nginx/bpq-dashboard.error.log
sudo tail -50 /var/log/nginx/error.log
sudo tail -50 /var/log/php*-fpm.log
sudo systemctl restart 'php*-fpm'
```

Log Viewer: "JSON.parse: unexpected end of data" on some logs

Up to v1.5.16 the Log Viewer's PHP sent an empty reply for any log holding bytes that aren't valid UTF-8 — usually the BBS-session logs (Message text job, Email Client (BBS), Dashboard log). Fixed in v1.5.17 (`admin/log-viewer-api.php` 1.3.1): those bytes show as **(replacement character)**. Update `admin/log-viewer-api.php` and `admin/log-viewer.html`, then reload with Ctrl+Shift+R. To see which lines of a log have such bytes:

```
LANG=C.UTF-8 grep -naxv '.*' /var/log/bpq-dashboard/bbs-messages.log | head
```

If the page now says *"Empty reply from the server"* or *"Server reply was not JSON"*, the PHP error is in the web-server error log (above).

YAPP transfer fails

- Are you in FBB mode? YAPP requires BPQ's FBB port (8011 by default), not the standard telnet port. If yours is different and the dashboard can't read `bpq32.cfg`, set `'fbb_port' => N` in the `bbs` section of `config.php` and restart bpq-telnet.
- Is bpq-telnet daemon running? `sudo systemctl status bpq-telnet`
- Check `/var/log/bpq-dashboard/bpq-telnet-daemon.log` for protocol errors (Admin → Logs → bpq-telnet).

Telnet or VARA page can't connect

- Is the service running? `sudo systemctl status bpq-telnet bpq-vara`
- Telnet: a port is refused, or the buttons show the wrong port — the page uses `bbs.port` from `config.php` and the FBB port from `bpq32.cfg` (or `bbs.fbb_port`). After changing `config.php`, `sudo systemctl restart bpq-telnet`; its log (Log Viewer → *bpq-telnet*) lists the allowed ports when it starts.
- Does the web server pass `/ws/telnet` and `/ws/vara` through? The installer's site file does from 2026-10-25; an older one doesn't — re-run the installer or copy the blocks from `nginx-bpq-dashboard.conf`.
- VARA: `sudo journalctl -u bpq-vara -n 30` shows the login, the VARA port it chose and the `ATT` reply (Section 9). NetROM list empty: the error under the list says whether the `bbs` login or `station.node` is the problem.

Chat or VARA terminal shows "daemon not connected"

```
sudo systemctl status bpq-chat bpq-vara
sudo journalctl -u bpq-chat -n 30
sudo systemctl restart bpq-chat
```

Email Client or message text job: "Login refused" / "Login failed"

The dashboard logs in with `bbs.user` / `bbs.pass` from `config.php`. The message names the step and the last line BPQ sent.

- *Login refused* — BPQ rejected the user name or password: make them match the `USER=` line in `bpq32.cfg`.
- *nothing came back after the password* — LinBPQ stopped answering; check it's running and the port (`bbs.port`) is its telnet port.
- *No BBS prompt after 'bbs'* — the BBS application has another name: set `bbs.alias` to it (`APPLICATION` line in `bpq32.cfg`).

- Plain *"Login failed"* on v1.5.17 or earlier: BPQ's greeting had no `}`; update to v1.5.18.

Test by hand: `sudo -u www-data php /var/www/bpq-dashboard/scripts/fetch-message-bodies.php --dry-run --limit=1`, or `telnet localhost <bbs.port>` and log in as the dashboard does.

"BBS password not configured" error

Open config.php and set `'pass'` under `'bbs'` (still `'CHANGE_THIS_PASSWORD'` in a copied example) to your BPQ sysop password.

Firewall page says the rules could not be read

The sudo rules are missing or out of date (see Security Hardening → Configure sudoers for www-data). Copy `www-data-tools.sudoers` again; sudo picks the change up at once, nothing needs restarting.

Rig Status shows "flrig offline"

The page now shows the actual error from the API. Common causes:

- flrig not running on the configured `flrig_host`
- flrig not connected to the radio (its title bar must show the radio model)
- Firewall blocking 12345/tcp between the server and the flrig computer
- Wrong host in config.php `radio.flrig_host`

```
# Test connectivity
nc -zv YOUR_FLRIG_HOST 12345

# Test flrig RPC
curl -s -X POST http://YOUR_FLRIG_HOST:12345/RPC2 \
  -H "Content-Type: text/xml" \
  -d '<?xml version="1.0"?><methodCall><methodName>rig.get_vfo</methodName><params></params></methodCall>'
```

Dashboard shows "No data" or blank charts

The web server cannot read your BPQ log files.

```
sudo -u www-data ls /var/www/bpq-dashboard/logs/
sudo -u www-data cat /var/www/bpq-dashboard/logs/log_$(date +%y%m%d)_BBS.txt | head -3
```

`Permission denied` with LinBPQ inside a home folder: see the next section.

LinBPQ in a home folder (Ubuntu 21.04+, Linux Mint 21+)

These systems make `/home/<user>` private, so the web server can't see a LinBPQ folder inside it: every log page stays empty, Traffic finds no reports. The installer (v1.5.19) checks this and offers the fix; Install Check's *LinBPQ folder* row prints these commands for your path. Example for `/home/n3mel/linbpq`:

```
sudo apt install -y acl
sudo setfacl -m u:www-data:x /home/n3mel                    # pass through only
sudo setfacl -m u:www-data:rx /home/n3mel/linbpq            # list the LinBPQ folder (Traffic_*.txt live
sudo setfacl -R -m u:www-data:rX /home/n3mel/linbpq/logs    # read the logs
sudo setfacl -d -m u:www-data:rX /home/n3mel/linbpq/logs    # ... and the ones LinBPQ writes later
sudo -u www-data ls /home/n3mel/linbpq/logs | tail -3       # test
```

The web server can't read anything else in the home folder, and `bpq32.cfg` (your BPQ passwords) stays closed; give it read on that one file only if you need the Rig page scan list or the VARA HF Terminal without `vara.bpq_port`. Don't `chmod 755` the home folder or add `www-data` to your group: both open the whole

home folder. Undo with `sudo setfacl -b <folder>`. Since v1.5.19 the dashboard writes its own logs to `/var/log/bpq-dashboard`, so it no longer needs write access to LinBPQ's logs folder.

Connect Log page is empty

BPQ writes `ConnectLog_YYMMDD.log` only with `LogAllConnects=1` in the main section of `bpq32.cfg` (before the first `PORT`). Add it, restart LinBPQ, and new connections appear. (`LOGGING=1` on the telnet port writes `Telnet_*.log`, which this page doesn't read.)

Permission denied on cache or data directories

```
sudo chown -R www-data:www-data /var/www/bpq-dashboard/cache /var/www/bpq-dashboard/data /var/www/bpq-dash
sudo chmod 750 /var/www/bpq-dashboard/cache /var/www/bpq-dashboard/data
```

`sudo bash /var/www/bpq-dashboard/fix-permissions.sh` (try `--dry-run` first) resets the whole folder to the installer's scheme.

APRS map shows no stations

Check daemon status and APRS-IS connection.

```
sudo systemctl status bpq-aprs
cat /var/www/bpq-dashboard/cache/aprs/aprs-daemon.json | python3 -m json.tool | head -10
```

Email Client says "BBS busy"

Only one session with the BBS runs at a time (Get Mail, the message-text job, the forwarding-queue check). It waits up to 40 seconds; try again. If it happens all the time, check `sudo journalctl -u message-bodies.service -n 20`.

A page is empty and its status has no "(DB)"

The database path failed. Check the parser logs in `/var/log/bpq-dashboard/`, `cat /etc/cron.d/bpq-dashboard`, and System Audit's *Database* and *Logs* rows.

Theme toggle doesn't work on a page

Hard-refresh the page (Ctrl+Shift+R). If still no response, clear the `bpq-dark-mode` localStorage key in browser DevTools.

13. Quick Reference

File locations (default install to /var/www/bpq-dashboard)

File / Directory	Purpose
`/var/www/bpq-dashboard/`	Dashboard web root
`/var/www/bpq-dashboard/config.php`	Main configuration (mode 640); `db-config.php` optionally holds the database login
`/var/www/bpq-dashboard/logs`	Link to LinBPQ's `logs` folder (BPQ logs, the VARA log, `nodesrtt.txt`)
`/var/log/bpq-dashboard/`	The dashboard's own logs: daemons, Email Client, message-text job, NWS posting, parsers, forwarding tools, VARA download (v1.5.19)
`/var/lib/bpq-dashboard/`	Copies the dashboard keeps (the PKTNET forms replaced by an update, for Undo)
`/var/www/bpq-dashboard/cache/`	Runtime state — managed automatically
`/var/www/bpq-dashboard/data/`	Partners lists, BBS station info, saved locations, backups
`/var/www/bpq-dashboard/yapp-files/`	Files received by YAPP (behind the admin login)
`/var/www/bpq-dashboard/scripts/`	Daemons, parsers and tools — the services run them from here
`/etc/systemd/system/`	`bpq-telnet`, `bpq-chat`, `bpq-aprs`, `bpq-vara`, `vara-logger`, `rig-history-poller` services; `message-bodies` and `bulletin-retention` timers
`/etc/cron.d/bpq-dashboard`	The three log parsers
`/var/log/bpq-dashboard/`	Parser logs
`/etc/nginx/sites-available/bpq-dashboard`	The installer's web-server site
`/etc/nginx/.bpq-mgmt-auth`	Admin login password file
`/etc/sudoers.d/www-data-tools`	Read-only sudo rules for Firewall Status and System Audit

Service management

```
# Status of the dashboard's services and timers
systemctl status bpq-telnet bpq-chat bpq-aprs bpq-vara vara-logger rig-history-poller --no-pager
systemctl list-timers message-bodies.timer bulletin-retention.timer nws-auto-post.timer

# Restart one
sudo systemctl restart bpq-telnet

# Logs
sudo journalctl -u bpq-telnet -n 50 --no-pager
tail -50 /var/log/bpq-dashboard/bpq-telnet-daemon.log
```

Services and timers

Service	What it does	Required for
nginx (or Apache)	Web server	Everything
php*-fpm	PHP	Everything
LinBPQ (`bpq` or `linbpq`)	The node, BBS and chat	Everything
MariaDB	Database	Email Client; fast RF Connections, Traffic, System Logs
bpq-telnet	Telnet WebSocket + YAPP bridge	Telnet Client, YAPP
bpq-chat	The station's chat connection	Chat
bpq-aprs	APRS-IS connection and BBS beacon	APRS Map
bpq-vara	VARA HF session bridge	VARA HF Terminal
vara-logger	Copies VARA log lines from syslog	RF Connections
rig-history-poller	Power/SWR history	RF Power Monitor
vara-validator *(optional)*	Callsign check in front of VARA	§10.9
message-bodies.timer	Saves message text every 5 minutes	Email Client
bulletin-retention.timer	Daily 14-day bulletin clean-up	Email Client
nws-auto-post.timer *(optional)*	Posts new NWS Warnings/Watches for your state every 5 minutes	Automatic NWS bulletins (§10.4)
vara-remote.timer *(optional, v1.5.19)*	Downloads the VARA log from the TPRFN server every 5 minutes	RF Connections on TPRFN stations (§10.11)

Complete crontab reference

```
# /etc/cron.d/bpq-dashboard — written by install.sh (runs as www-data)
*/5 * * * * www-data /usr/bin/python3 /var/www/bpq-dashboard/scripts/parse-vara-log.py --bbs-log-dir /var/
*/5 * * * * www-data /usr/bin/python3 /var/www/bpq-dashboard/scripts/parse-traffic-report.py --days 8 >> /
*/5 * * * * www-data /usr/bin/python3 /var/www/bpq-dashboard/scripts/parse-system-logs.py >> /var/log/bpq-

# Optional — root's crontab (sudo crontab -e)
*/5 * * * * /usr/bin/python3 /var/www/bpq-dashboard/scripts/connect-watchdog.py
0 * * * * /usr/bin/python3 /var/www/bpq-dashboard/scripts/storm-monitor.py >> /var/log/bpq-dashboard/storm
0 6 */2 * * /usr/bin/python3 /var/www/bpq-dashboard/scripts/prop-scheduler.py --apply >> /var/log/bpq-dash
*/10 * * * * /var/www/bpq-dashboard/nodes-rtt.sh
0 2 * * 0 DASHBOARD_DIR=/var/www/bpq-dashboard /var/www/bpq-dashboard/scripts/archive-bpq-data.sh >> /var/
0 3 * * 0 find /var/www/bpq-dashboard/yapp-files/ -mtime +30 -type f -delete

# Optional — www-data's crontab (sudo crontab -u www-data -e), run from the LinBPQ folder
0 3 * * * cd /opt/linbpq && python3 /var/www/bpq-dashboard/scripts/wp_manager.py --auto-clean >> /var/log/
```

The message-text job and the bulletin clean-up are systemd timers, not cron lines.

Dashboard URLs at a glance

Replace `YOUR_SERVER_IP` with your server's actual IP or hostname.

Page	URL
RF Connections (home)	`http://YOUR_SERVER_IP/`
Chat Client	`http://YOUR_SERVER_IP/bpq-chat.html`
VARA HF Terminal	`http://YOUR_SERVER_IP/bpq-vara.html`
Telnet Client	`http://YOUR_SERVER_IP/bpq-telnet.html`
System Logs	`http://YOUR_SERVER_IP/bpq-system-logs.html`
Traffic Report	`http://YOUR_SERVER_IP/bpq-traffic.html`
Email Client	`http://YOUR_SERVER_IP/bbs-messages.html`
Message Monitor	`http://YOUR_SERVER_IP/bpq-email-monitor.html`
Connect Log	`http://YOUR_SERVER_IP/bpq-connect-log.html`
RF Power Monitor	`http://YOUR_SERVER_IP/rf-power-monitor.html`
Rig Status	`http://YOUR_SERVER_IP/rig-status.html`
APRS Map	`http://YOUR_SERVER_IP/bpq-aprs.html`
NWS Weather	`http://YOUR_SERVER_IP/nws-dashboard.html`
Maintenance	`http://YOUR_SERVER_IP/admin/bpq-maintenance.html`
Firewall Status	`http://YOUR_SERVER_IP/admin/firewall-status.html`
Log Viewer	`http://YOUR_SERVER_IP/admin/log-viewer.html`
System Audit	`http://YOUR_SERVER_IP/admin/system-audit.html`
Install Check	`http://YOUR_SERVER_IP/install-check.php` (admin login)
Health Check	`http://YOUR_SERVER_IP/health-check.php` (admin login)
NTS Report	`http://YOUR_SERVER_IP/nts-forwarding-report.php` (admin login)
User Guide (PDF)	`http://YOUR_SERVER_IP/BPQ-Dashboard-v1.5.19-User-Guide.pdf`

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Open source · https://github.com/bpq-dashboard/bpq-dashboard